



GÖTEBORGS  
UNIVERSITET

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

# WHO SHOULD PAY?

## A Comparative Analysis of Justice Framings in Climate Finance Negotiations

AUTHOR: SINA OCKERT

---

|                  |                                                                          |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Master's Thesis: | 30 credits                                                               |
| Programme:       | Master's Programme in International Administration and Global Governance |
| Date:            | 25.05.2026                                                               |
| Supervisor:      | Frederik Pfeiffer (PhD Candidate) and Göran Duus-Otterström (Professor)  |
| Words:           | 18.325                                                                   |

In a few instances, DeepL was used to translate sections of the submission documents more efficiently. All translated passages were then carefully reviewed and checked for accuracy. For spelling and grammar corrections, Grammarly was employed. Beyond this, no additional AI tools were used.

## **Abstract**

International climate finance negotiations have increasingly become arenas in which competing understandings of justice are strategically employed. This study examines how three UNFCCC coalitions – the EU, AOSIS, and, LMDC – frame paying principles for climate finance provision within the New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) negotiations and which climate justice theories underpin their positions. The research applies a qualitative frame analysis to official coalition submissions from 2022-2024 alongside the final NCQG decision text adopted at COP29. The analysis operationalises distributive, corrective, and climate debt justice as analytical categories and distinguishes between fault-based (FB) and non-fault-based (N-FB) paying principles. The findings reveal a clear divide in the use of paying principles and climate justice framings among the coalitions. The EU primarily relies on distributive and N-FB framings, emphasising global effort, capability, and a broader contributor base. In contrast, the Like Minded Developing Countries (LMDC), including countries like China and India, strongly employ corrective and climate debt justice framings supported by FB principles centred on historical responsibility and reparative obligations of developed countries. The Alliance of Small Island States (AOSIS) predominantly relies on climate debt justice, followed by corrective justice, combining FB and N-FB principles more evenly. The final NCQG decision text, however, mainly reflects N-FB principles, particularly debt burden and global effort framings, representing a political compromise between competing justice logics. The thesis contributes to existing research on climate finance negotiations by highlighting the growing importance of climate finance quality and demonstrating that NCGQ negotiations remain shaped by competing interpretations of justice and responsibility.

# TABLE OF CONTENTS

|        |                                                                            |    |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 1.     | Introduction .....                                                         | 1  |
| 2.     | Literature Review .....                                                    | 3  |
| 2.1.   | Climate Finance Foundations .....                                          | 4  |
| 2.2.   | Climate Finance Justice Claims in Climate Negotiations .....               | 5  |
| 2.2.1. | Developed, Developing, and Emerging Economy Climate Justice Positions .... | 6  |
| 2.3.   | Research Gap .....                                                         | 7  |
| 3.     | Theory .....                                                               | 9  |
| 3.1.   | Climate justice theories .....                                             | 10 |
| 3.1.1. | Distributive climate justice .....                                         | 11 |
| 3.1.2. | Corrective justice .....                                                   | 12 |
| 3.1.3. | Climate debt justice .....                                                 | 13 |
| 3.2.   | Fault-Based and Non-Fault-Based Principles .....                           | 15 |
| 4.     | Analytical Framework .....                                                 | 15 |
| 4.1.   | Theoretical Expectations .....                                             | 16 |
| 5.     | Methods And Data .....                                                     | 17 |
| 5.1.   | Research Design .....                                                      | 18 |
| 5.2.   | Method .....                                                               | 19 |
| 5.3.   | Data .....                                                                 | 20 |
| 6.     | Analysis .....                                                             | 21 |
| 6.1.   | Inductive frames .....                                                     | 22 |
| 6.1.1. | Global effort .....                                                        | 22 |
| 6.1.2. | Solidarity .....                                                           | 22 |
| 6.1.3. | Equity and Fairness .....                                                  | 22 |
| 6.1.4. | Lessons learned .....                                                      | 23 |
| 6.1.5. | Debt burdens .....                                                         | 23 |
| 6.2.   | Contributor Base .....                                                     | 23 |
| 6.2.2. | Results Contributor Base .....                                             | 24 |
| 6.3.   | The EU .....                                                               | 25 |

|      |                                                               |    |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 6.4. | The AOSIS .....                                               | 27 |
| 6.5. | The LMDC .....                                                | 29 |
| 6.6. | Comparison between Coalitions.....                            | 30 |
| 6.7. | Decision 1/CMA.6 – NCQG .....                                 | 34 |
| 7.   | Discussion .....                                              | 35 |
| 7.1. | Usage of Climate Justice Theories and Paying Principles ..... | 35 |
| 7.2. | Final decision document.....                                  | 38 |
| 7.3. | Implications .....                                            | 40 |
| 7.4. | Limitations .....                                             | 40 |
| 7.5. | Further research.....                                         | 42 |
| 8.   | Conclusion.....                                               | 43 |
|      | References .....                                              | i  |
|      | Appendix .....                                                | 1  |

## List of Tables

|         |                                                                               |    |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| Table 1 | Overview of climate justice theories with the corresponding paying principles | 22 |
| Table 2 | Residuals regarding use of climate justice theories across coalitions         | 31 |
| Table 3 | Residuals regarding use of climate justice theories across coalitions         | 32 |
| Table 4 | Support of theoretical expectations.                                          | 36 |

## List of Figures

|           |                                                                   |    |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| Figure 1. | Justice matrix.                                                   | 11 |
| Figure 2. | Coalition's opinion regarding broadening the contributor base.    | 24 |
| Figure 3. | Frames used by the EU.                                            | 25 |
| Figure 4. | Frames used by the AOSIS.                                         | 27 |
| Figure 5. | Frames used by the LMDC.                                          | 29 |
| Figure 6. | Climate justice theory frames by coalition.                       | 31 |
| Figure 7. | FB and N-FB principle use by coalition.                           | 32 |
| Figure 8. | Principle use by coalition.                                       | 33 |
| Figure 9. | Climate justice theory and principle usage in the final decision. | 34 |

## Appendices

|              |                                                                    |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Appendix A.  | Preliminary justice framework.                                     |
| Appendix B1. | Member countries of the EU.                                        |
| Appendix B2. | Member countries of the AOSIS.                                     |
| Appendix B3. | Member countries of the LMDC.                                      |
| Appendix C1. | Documents of analysis.                                             |
| Appendix D1. | Final framework.                                                   |
| Appendix D2. | Text-Examples of final frames.                                     |
| Appendix D3. | Text-Examples of contributor base.                                 |
| Appendix E1. | Variations in use of climate justice theories across coalitions    |
| Appendix E2  | Calculation of Cramer's V effect size for a 3x3 contingency table. |
| Appendix E3. | Variations in frame use of paying principles across coalitions.    |

## List of Abbreviations

|        |                                                                                        |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AHWP   | Ad Hoc Work Program                                                                    |
| AOSIS  | Alliance of Small Island States                                                        |
| APP    | Ability to Pay Principle                                                               |
| BL     | Backward-looking                                                                       |
| BPP    | Beneficiary Pays Principle                                                             |
| CBDR   | Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities                 |
| CDA    | Critical discourse analysis                                                            |
| CMA    | Conference of the Parties serving as the meeting of the Parties to the Paris Agreement |
| COP    | Conference of the Parties                                                              |
| EU     | European Union                                                                         |
| FB     | Fault-based                                                                            |
| FL     | Forward-looking                                                                        |
| GHG    | Greenhouse gas                                                                         |
| LMDC   | Like Minded Developing Countries                                                       |
| L&D    | Loss and Damage                                                                        |
| NCQG   | New Collective Quantified Goal                                                         |
| N-FB   | Non-fault-based                                                                        |
| PA     | Paris Agreement                                                                        |
| PPP    | Polluter Pays Principle                                                                |
| SIDS   | Small Island Developing States                                                         |
| TED    | Technical Expert Dialogues                                                             |
| UNFCCC | United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change                                  |
| UPP    | User Pays Principle                                                                    |

# 1. INTRODUCTION

The 2024 United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) Conference of the Parties in Baku (COP29) marked a critical turning point in the global climate finance architecture with the adoption of the New Collective Quantified Goal on Climate Finance (NCQG) (Khan et al., 2026; UNFCCC, 2024b). Replacing the previous USD 100 billion annual target, first agreed upon at COP15 (Nhamo & Nhamo, 2016), the NCQG established a goal “of at least USD 300 billion per year by 2035” from developed to developing countries and also foresees the mobilisation of “at least USD 1.3 trillion per year by 2035” from “all public and private sources” (UNFCCC, 2024b, p.2). The agreement therefore represents a major transformation in the scale and structure of international climate finance.

Due to countries historical unequal contributions to global greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions and their uneven exposure to climate impacts (Bastos & Duleba, 2025; Cipler et al., 2015; IPCC, 2023a), climate finance has long been linked to questions of climate justice (Audet, 2013; Harlan et al., 2015). The UNFCCC establishes that developed countries should “provide[...] financial resources to” (Weikmans & Roberts, 2019, p.108) assist developing countries for mitigation and adaptation efforts. Indeed, over the past decade, climate justice has become a key language through which states articulate claims regarding responsibility, fairness, and support within the global climate regime (Okereke & Coventry, 2016). As the primary decision-making body of the UNFCCC, the COP has therefore become the central arena in which competing interpretations of climate justice are articulated and negotiated (Mahendru et al., 2025).

The negotiations surrounding the NCQG illustrate the continued salience of these justice debates. The three-year deliberation process preceding COP29 revealed significant disagreements among coalitions regarding the normative principles that should determine who contributes to climate finance and on what basis (Watson et al., 2025). These disputes concern the “principles to pay”, meaning the normative justifications through which actors define financial responsibility (Massenberg, 2021). The NCQG negotiations therefore, reflect deeper tensions about responsibility, equity, and fairness in global climate governance.

Despite the increasing prominence of climate justice in UNFCCC negotiations, existing research has only partially examined how justice arguments are mobilised in climate finance debates. Previous scholarship has mostly focused on specific policy areas such as adaptation or Loss and Damage (L&D) (Bastos & Duleba, 2025; Calliari, 2018; Khan et al., 2019). More



broadly, studies addressing climate finance justice have often examined the principles of paying and receiving as interconnected dimensions of fairness within the international climate regime (Caney, 2018; Ciple et al., 2013; Davidson, 2021; Khan et al., 2019; Paavola & Adger, 2006). However, comparatively little research has systematically analysed how states frame the responsibility for providing climate finance in relation to major transitions in the architecture of global finance commitments, such as the shift from the USD 100 billion pledge to the NCQG (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024).

This thesis addresses this gap by examining the principles of paying and the ways in which states justify financial responsibility in the context of the NCQG negotiations. It asks the following research question:

*RQ: How do UNFCCC parties frame the principles for paying towards the New Collective Quantified Goal at COP29, and which climate justice logics underpin their positions?*

To answer this question more in detail, the thesis addresses two sub-questions:

*SQ1: How do paying principles differ between developed, developing, and emerging parties in their NCQG arguments?*

*SQ2: Which principles will ultimately prevail in the final decision document?<sup>1</sup>*

The NCQG negotiations leading up to COP29 provide a particularly relevant case for analysing these debates. As the negotiations responsible for establishing the first global climate finance target beyond the USD 100 billion goal, they offer a unique opportunity to observe how coalitions articulate and negotiate competing justice claims regarding financial responsibility.

The study makes several contributions. Methodologically, it applies a qualitative frame analysis, examining how coalitions justify their positions on climate finance related to the NCQG. Empirically, it contributes by focusing on the interaction between the EU – a major provider of climate finance (SEKK Development, n.d.) –, the Alliance of Small Island States (AOSIS), which is recognised as "particularly vulnerable" to climate impacts within the UNFCCC framework (IPCC, 1990; UNFCCC, 1992), and the Like Minded Developing Countries (LMDC), which include emerging economies that are simultaneously major emitters (Crippa et al., 2025; Halkyer, 2021). Theoretically, by examining how these actors frame financial responsibility, the thesis provides new insights into how climate justice principles shape debates on the future architecture of global climate finance.

---

<sup>1</sup> Research Question (RQ) and Sub Questions (SQ1&2).

This thesis proceeds in five steps. First, it reviews the literature on climate finance and climate justice positions within the UNFCCC regime. Second, it develops the theoretical framework on climate justice theories and principles guiding financial responsibility. Third, the methodology section outlines the qualitative frame analysis used to examine coalition positions regarding the NCQG. Fourth, the empirical analysis compares how the three coalitions – EU, AOSIS, and LMDC – frame principles of paying and their underlying climate justice theories and examines how these frames are reflected in the final NCQG decision. Finally, the discussion interprets the findings in light of existing literature and assesses their implications for future climate finance negotiations.

## **2. LITERATURE REVIEW**

Research on UNFCCC climate negotiations has expanded considerably over recent decades, increasingly incorporating perspectives from political science, international relations, law, and environmental governance (Brunnée & Streck, 2013; Genovese, 2013; Saerbeck et al., 2020). While early negotiations primarily focused on mitigation and emission reductions, climate finance gradually evolved into a central pillar of global climate governance (IPCC, 2023b; Kuyper et al., 2018). Although no universally accepted definition of climate finance exists (Weikmans & Roberts, 2019), the UNFCCC broadly defines it as “financing [...] from public, private and alternative sources support[ing] mitigation and adaptation actions” (UNFCCC, n.d.b).

As climate finance has gained importance within the UNFCCC regime, debates over its fair provision and allocation intensified, raising broader questions of climate justice (Dafermos, 2025; Islam, 2022). Climate justice generally refers to addressing the uneven impacts of climate change and responding to them in equitable ways (Sultana, 2022). These concerns are particularly relevant in negotiations on the NCQG, since climate finance negotiations are not simply “cheap talk”, but rather oblige parties to agree – at least on paper – on actual volumes, contributors, and instruments (Ciplet et al., 2012; Kowalzig et al., 2025; OECD, 2024).

Against this background, this chapter situates the research aim within the existing literature by outlining the institutionalisation of climate finance under the UNFCCC and examining how climate justice positions are articulated and contested in these negotiations. It thereby identifies the main justice debates surrounding climate finance and highlights the research gaps addressed by this study.

## **2.1. CLIMATE FINANCE FOUNDATIONS**

Climate finance has become one of the most contested dimensions of global climate governance, as negotiations increasingly revolve around questions of who should provide financial resources, under which conditions, and according to which principles of justice (Ciplet et al., 2013; Khan et al., 2019). Since the establishment of the UNFCCC in 1992, climate finance has been closely linked to the principle of Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities (CBDR-RC), obliging developed countries to support developing countries in addressing climate change (Colenbrander et al., 2023; Munira et al., 2021).

While climate finance has become a central pillar in the UNFCCC framework, particularly since the Bali Action Plan (2007) and the Copenhagen Accords (2009), it has become increasingly institutionalised through quantified commitments and dedicated financial mechanisms (Colenbrander et al., 2023; Weikmans & Roberts, 2019). The most significant benchmark was the pledge by developed countries to mobilise USD 100 billion annually by 2020, later extended until 2025 under the Paris Agreement (PA) (UNFCCC, 2015; Weikmans & Roberts, 2019).

However, the implementation of this goal has remained highly contested. Although the OECD declared the target achieved in 2022 (OECD, 2024), a substantial body of literature questions these figures due to accounting practices, the inclusion of non-concessional loans, and the relabelling of existing Official Development Assistance as climate finance (Khan et al., 2019; Kowalzig et al., 2025; Pauw, 2025; Zagema et al., 2023). The absence of a universally agreed definition of climate finance further complicates reporting and fuels mistrust between providers and recipients (Munira et al., 2021; Weikmans & Roberts, 2019). Consequently, climate finance debates increasingly focus not only on the quantity of finance but also on its quality, accessibility, and distributive implications (Islam, 2022; Tan & Pettinotti, 2024).

Criticism has also focused on the fragmented international climate finance architecture and the barriers developing countries face in accessing funding. Complex application procedures, reporting requirements, and the dominance of loan-based finance have raised concerns that climate finance may reproduce existing inequalities and create additional debt burdens for vulnerable countries (Ciplet et al., 2022; Kowalzig et al., 2025; Pickering et al., 2017). These debates have become especially prominent in negotiations surrounding the NCQG, where disputes concern not only the scale of finance mobilisation, but also who should contribute and in what form finance should be delivered (Pettinotti et al., 2024).

Against this background, climate finance negotiations have become closely linked to competing interpretations of climate justice. Questions of responsibility, burden-sharing, vulnerability<sup>2</sup>, and historical emissions are increasingly used by negotiating coalitions to legitimise their preferred policy positions (Audet, 2013; Massenberg, 2021). However, these climate justice framings within the NCQG negotiations remain largely unexplored.

## **2.2. CLIMATE FINANCE JUSTICE CLAIMS IN CLIMATE NEGOTIATIONS**

Climate justice has become a central analytical lens for understanding international climate negotiations (Gach, 2019; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024), particularly regarding the unequal distribution of climate impacts, responsibilities, and response capacities (Okereke, 2010). Accordingly, climate finance has received growing attention within UNFCCC negotiations, with references to climate finance in national reports rising significantly after the Kyoto Protocol entered into force (Genovese, 2013). Existing scholarship shows that negotiations are shaped by competing normative claims over who should bear the costs of climate change and according to which principles responsibilities should be allocated (Audet, 2013; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024).

Climate justice does not represent a unified concept but encompasses competing understandings of fairness, responsibility, and obligation (Gardiner, 2004; Okereke & Coventry, 2016; Schlosberg & Collins, 2014). Empirical studies demonstrate that negotiating parties strategically employed justice claims to legitimise demands for financial support, resist obligations, and contest burden-sharing arrangements (Calliari, 2018; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). Within the UNFCCC, these positions are frequently articulated through bargaining coalitions that pool resources, expertise, and negotiating power (Klöck et al., 2021, 2025). Coalition politics therefore, play a central role in climate finance negotiations and form the focus of this analysis.

The use of climate justice framings has increased considerably over time (Gach, 2019). Earlier scholarship largely identified a divide between developed and developing countries (Gach, 2019; Okereke & Coventry, 2016). However, the rise of emerging economies such as China and India has increasingly complicated this binary distinction, leading recent research to

---

<sup>2</sup> Although vulnerability is defined in various ways within the literature (Cutter et al., 2009; Nelson et al., 2010), most studies rely on the definition from the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC), which describes vulnerability as the “propensity or predisposition to be adversely affected” (IPCC, 2014, p. 1775) by climate change impacts (see also Adger, 2006; Islam, 2022; Pacifici et al., 2015). Existing research further emphasises that vulnerability extends beyond geographic exposure to climate risks, such as sea-level rise, and is closely linked to socioeconomic inequalities that constrain communities’ capacities to adapt and recover from climate-related disasters (Bohle et al., 1994; Kashwan, 2021; Wallimann-Helmer, 2015).

differentiate between developed countries, vulnerable developing states, and emerging economies (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024).

Existing research primarily focuses on broader climate negotiations (Genovese, 2013; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024), the Paris Agreement (Nhamo & Nhamo, 2016), the USD 100 billion goal (Audet, 2013), adaptation finance (Khan et al., 2019), and Loss and Damage negotiations (Calliari, 2018). While these studies provide important insights into climate justice claims, qualitative analyses of justice framings in the NCQG negotiations remain limited.

### **2.2.1. DEVELOPED, DEVELOPING, AND EMERGING ECONOMY CLIMATE JUSTICE POSITIONS**

Research shows that developed countries increasingly employ climate justice language in international negotiations, although generally less extensively than developing countries (Gach, 2019). Their positions are commonly associated with international integration, compliance, and leadership (Genovese, 2013). Developed countries, particularly the EU, tend to promote a liberal-egalitarian understanding of climate justice that frames climate action as an opportunity for economic growth (Audet, 2013; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024; Nhamo & Nhamo, 2016). While acknowledging responsibilities regarding climate finance, developed countries generally avoid references to historical blame or liability. Instead, climate finance is framed as support for countries with lower economic and technological capacities or as part of a broader responsibility toward future generations (Audet, 2013; Okereke & Coventry, 2016). Similarly, developed countries have largely resisted compensation-based approaches in L&D negotiations, favouring disaster risk management framings instead (Calliari, 2018). At the same time, the United States have advocated for a broader contributor base, while the EU has promoted stronger private sector involvement in climate finance (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024; Okereke & Coventry, 2016).

Developing countries, by contrast, rely more strongly on climate justice framings (Gach, 2019), particularly fairness, equity, and the principle of CBDR-RC constitutes the basis for developing countries' justice claims (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024; Nhamo & Nhamo, 2016; Okereke & Coventry, 2016). Furthermore, historical responsibility and calls for aid provisions have played an important role for developing countries (Genovese, 2013). They frequently frame climate finance as a "moral obligation of 'developed' nations" and reject the notion of private finance provisions (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). Furthermore, developing countries have also become leading advocates of climate debt and requesting developed countries to pay back the debts owed due to the overuse of the atmospheric common good (Ciplet, 2017; Khan et al., 2019;

Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). Within L&D negotiations, especially Small Island Developing States (SIDS) have called for compensation, arguing that countries “least responsible for climate change” (Calliari, 2018, p. 735) are often the most severely affected.

Recent scholarship increasingly distinguishes emerging economies from other developing countries, highlighting their intermediary position within climate negotiations. Genovese (2013) describes these actors as “dynamic brokers” that occupy a middle ground between developed and developing countries. Emerging economies continue to emphasise historical responsibility while simultaneously defending their right to development and economic growth (Okereke & Coventry, 2016). This position enables them to resist attempts to broaden legally binding climate finance obligations toward major emerging emitters such as China and India (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). In L&D negotiations, emerging economies have aligned with broader developing country coalitions supporting compensation claims (Calliari, 2018).

### **2.3. RESEARCH GAP**

Research on climate justice in global climate governance has advanced considerably over the past two decades. Longitudinal studies trace how justice claims have evolved across COP negotiations (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024), while critical discourse analyses of specific agenda items, such as L&D, examine how parties frame climate impacts as compensable harms, humanitarian concerns, or risk management (Calliari, 2018). Other studies explore how climate justice discourses shape participation, inclusion, and mobilization, examining the role of youth, Indigenous, and Global South actors and analyzing how their claims are filtered or depoliticized within multilateral processes (Chaplain, 2025; Grosse & Mark, 2020; Okereke & Coventry, 2016). Taken together, this literature demonstrates that climate justice has become a central language of contestation in UN climate politics rather than a marginal normative add-on.

Yet, despite this growing body of scholarship, four important limitations remain. First, the justice dimensions of quantified climate finance targets remain underexplored. Existing research largely focuses either on estimating financial needs for mitigation, adaptation, and L&D in developing countries (CPI, 2019; Falduto et al., 2024; Flåm & Skjærseth, 2009; Isah et al., 2025; UNCTAD, 2014) or on tracking the quantitative progress toward the USD 100 billion goal (OECD, 2024; Weikmans & Roberts, 2019). These contributions provide valuable empirical insights into flows, accounting practices, and gaps between pledges and delivery.

However, comparatively little research has examined how justice positions are articulated in relation to international quantified climate finance targets themselves, which require states to

commit concrete financial resources rather than merely endorse general aspirations. Most justice-oriented studies focus on specific policy areas such as adaptation or L&D rather than on the overarching finance goals (Bastos & Duleba, 2025; Calliari, 2018; Khan et al., 2019). Limiting the analysis to a single finance area leaves justice framings in other areas largely unexplored, creating blind spots in how states articulate and prioritize equity concerns across issues. Analysing the overall goal instead provides a more comprehensive perspective on how countries negotiate and justify justice-related trade-offs between mitigation, adaptation, and loss-and-damage finance.

This constitutes a significant omission. The NCQG represents a structural shift from the 100 billion pledge toward the mobilisation of substantially larger financial resources for developing countries (Cherry-Virdee, 2025; Gabbatiss, 2024). Furthermore, while the USD 100 billion goal was explicitly a developed countries' commitment, the NCQG extends expectations to “all providers” from “all public and private sources”, raising questions about evolving responsibilities and dynamic burden-sharing over time (UNFCCC, 2025). Whether and how parties justify increases and changes in financial commitments through specific normative principles for who should pay – and on what moral basis – remains an open empirical question.

Second, corrective and climate debt logics remain under-operationalised in empirical climate politics research. Climate justice theory offers a rich repertoire of concepts, including distributive, procedural, recognition, compensatory, and corrective justice (Caney, 2005; Fraser, 1998; Jafino et al., 2021; Rawls, 1971; Shue, 1993; Young, 1990). While distributive and procedural justice are frequently analysed (Chaplain, 2025; Davidson, 2021; Islam, 2022; Kashwan, 2021; Klöck et al., 2025), corrective and climate debt perspectives, while prominent in normative theory and civil society advocacy, are rarely applied systematically to climate finance negotiations (Khan et al., 2019). As a result, it remains unclear whether NCQG debates reflect deeper notions of owed compensation and climate debt, particularly among key developed and developing country groups.

Third, research predominantly focuses on COP negotiations, while discussions within other UNFCCC bodies, such as Subsidiary Bodies or ad hoc working programs (AHWP) remain comparatively underexplored (Calliari, 2018; Chaplain, 2025). Although COPs play a key role in formal decision-making (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024), these additional forums are crucial for shaping negotiations and framing key issues. This thesis addresses this gap by analysing a broad range of NCQG-related UNFCCC documents.

Finally, methodological approaches to justice in COP negotiations remain heavily concentrated on critical discourse analysis (CDA), which examines structural power asymmetries (Calliari, 2018; Hijrah & Valiantien, 2026; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). While CDA has been effective in uncovering implicit hierarchies and marginalisation within multilateral negotiations, it often prioritises structural critique over systematic comparison of explicitly articulated normative principles. By contrast, qualitative frame analysis – which identifies and compares how actors construct, justify, and legitimise particular principles (Entman, 1993) – remains largely absent from studies of climate finance bargaining. This methodological gap leaves unexplored how coalitions construct and legitimise principles of paying in NCQG negotiations.

This thesis addresses these limitations by systematically connecting climate justice theory to the study of paying principles in NCQG negotiations at COP29.

Conceptually, it operationalizes distributive, corrective, and climate debt justice as frame categories and examines whether and how parties draw on these logics when legitimizing or contesting who and on what basis should contribute to the new global climate finance goal. In doing so, it moves beyond the procedural emphasis that dominates prior empirical work and foregrounds the normative foundations of paying obligations.

Methodologically, the study employs qualitative frame analysis to identify and compare justice logics in NCQG-related decision texts and coalition statements. This approach enables a systematic assessment of how financial obligations are discursively constructed and justified.

Empirically, coalition submissions provides a unique opportunity to observe how climate justice theories are translated into concrete claims about who must finance global climate action.

### **3. THEORY**

Climate justice is an ethical and human-rights-based approach<sup>3</sup> to the climate crisis that emphasizes how “those who have contributed [...] least” (OHCH, 2015) to GHG emissions – such as low-income countries, poor communities, and future generations – disproportionately suffer its environmental and health harms (Caney, 2010; Levy & Patz, 2015; Sultana, 2022). As Gardiner (2004) argues, climate change raises profound ethical challenges because its

---

<sup>3</sup> Climate change has major social and health consequences, including declining agricultural productivity, reduced “access to safe water” (Levy & Patz, 2015, p. 310), the spread of diseases, and displacement caused by extreme weather events and sea-level rise (ibid). These impacts disproportionately affect vulnerable groups such as low-income communities, minorities, women, children, and the elderly. Consequently, climate change threatens fundamental human rights, “including rights to life, [...] food and water, health, security, shelter, and culture” (Levy & Patz, 2015, p. 310). Climate justice therefore, adopts a human-rights-based approach, protecting these rights addressing the unequal distribution of climate-related harms.



causes, responsibilities, and impacts are unevenly distributed across countries and generations. Climate justice seeks to address these inequities by ensuring that the “benefits and burdens of climate action” (Bastos & Duleba, 2025, p. 4) are distributed fairly, with particular attention to protecting vulnerable populations and the realization of the right to development (Robinson & Shine, 2018).

The following section examines three climate justice theories – distributive justice, corrective justice, and climate debt – and reviews the underlying key principles for paying<sup>4</sup> discussed in the climate justice literature.

### **3.1. CLIMATE JUSTICE THEORIES**

The debate surrounding the NCQG centers on which states are responsible for providing climate finance and how these obligations should be distributed. However, competing climate justice theories offer distinct normative and temporal understandings of responsibility.

One key distinction of climate justice theories concerns the temporal scope. Backward-looking (BL) approaches emphasise historical responsibility by linking climate finance obligations to past emissions, cumulative contributions to climate change, and the need to rectify resulting harms. (Caney, 2005; Jagers & Duus-Otterström, 2008).

In contrast, forward-looking (FL) approaches prioritise present capabilities and future responsibilities, focusing on the equitable distribution of climate action according to current capacities (Massenberg, 2021; Paavola & Adger, 2006).

Climate justice theories can further be differentiated according to whether they emphasize fairness-based or responsibility-based principles. Fairness-based approaches focus on the equitable allocation of obligations by considering the circumstances of each actor, such as need, capacity, and opportunity (Caney, 2018; Islam, 2022; Shue, 1999). This thesis adopts a Rawlsian understanding of fairness, according to which both equal and unequal distribution may still be considered just if they ultimately benefit the least advantaged (Rawls, 1971).

Responsibility-based approaches, by contrast, derive obligations from causal contributions to climate change, particularly GHG emissions, thereby identifying actors responsible for climate-related harms (Jagers & Duus-Otterström, 2008).

---

<sup>4</sup> The legitimacy of most of these principles has been extensively discussed in the literature, but is not part of this thesis. For more information on the discussions, read Caney, 2005, 2018; Neumayer, 2000; Page, 2012; K. Tan, 2023.

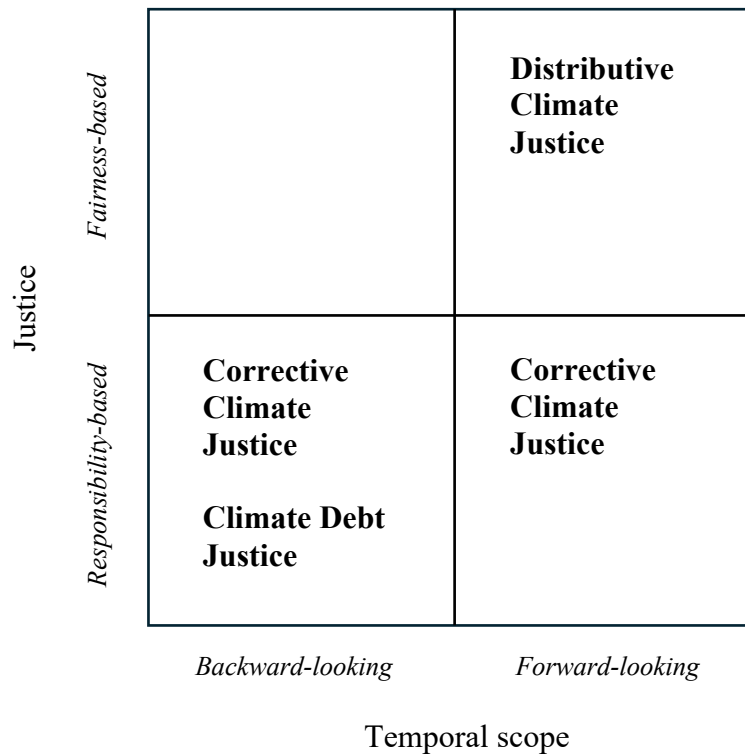


Figure 1. Justice matrix

Although the literature discusses a wide range of climate justice theories, this thesis focuses on distributive, corrective, and climate debt justice. Figure 1 illustrates how these theories can be separated into the broader categories outlined above. The categories, however, are not mutually exclusive; notably, corrective climate justice spans across BL and FL responsibility-based dimensions. These three theories are particularly relevant for analysing how climate finance obligations and paying principles are framed within the NCQG negotiations.

### 3.1.1. DISTRIBUTIVE CLIMATE JUSTICE

Distributive climate justice focuses on the equitable allocation of the costs, burdens, and benefits associated with climate action (Chaplain, 2025; Kashwan, 2021). While utilitarian approaches prioritise maximizing overall welfare, this thesis adopts a Rawlsian perspective that prioritises the situation of the least advantaged (Jafino et al., 2021). According to Rawls (1971), justice requires an equal distribution of “basic rights and duties” (p.2). However, inequalities may be considered just if they ultimately benefit the most vulnerable groups (Rawls, 1971). Consequently, distributive justice emphasizes “[e]quity and fairness”, prioritizing the needs of the most vulnerable (Khan et al., 2019, p. 252). Therefore, actors with greater resources and institutional capacities carry a moral obligation to support countries most affected by climate change (Bastos & Duleba, 2025; Khan et al., 2019; Okereke, 2010).

Distinct from other frameworks, distributive justice is primarily forward-looking, as responsibilities are derived from present capabilities and responsibilities, rather than past wrongdoings.<sup>5</sup> It therefore focuses less on compensating historical harm and more on achieving an equitable distribution of climate burdens and benefits (Okereke, 2010; Thornton, 2021). Since climate change represents a global challenge that transcends borders, burdens should be shared according to principles of equity among all capable actors (Bastos & Duleba, 2025). Climate finance is thus framed not as charity, but as part of a fair system of global cooperation (Khan et al., 2019).

Within both academic literature and international negotiations, distributive justice is most commonly operationalised through the Ability to Pay Principle (APP) (Adelman, 2016; Paavola & Adger, 2006). As a “no-fault” principle, the APP holds that the most advantaged actors – with greater financial, technological, and institutional resources – should bear a bigger share to climate finance provisions (Moss, 2009; Shue, 1999; Wallimann-Helmer, 2015). It is a “synchronic” approach that looks at what parties possess in the present to determine their capacity to contribute (Caney, 2005).<sup>6</sup>

### **3.1.2. CORRECTIVE JUSTICE**

Corrective justice (also referred to as compensatory or rectificatory justice) focuses on addressing wrongful losses and harms and restoring disturbed balances between actors (Okereke, 2010; Thornton, 2021). Unlike distributive justice, which concerns the fair allocation of burdens and benefits, corrective justice targets remedies for specific wrongs where one party’s actions infringe another’s rights or interests (Khan et al., 2019).

Most scholars identify corrective justice as a BL approach, grounded in historical responsibility and the obligation to rectify past damages caused by GHG emissions (Caney, 2018; Jagers & Duus-Otterström, 2008). However, Shue (1999) argues that corrective justice can also be FL by assigning responsibility to current and future polluters. Central to corrective justice is the idea of restoring, as far as possible, the status quo ante, meaning the situation that would have existed without the harmful act (Goodin, 1989). In practice, this is most commonly pursued through compensation (McKinnon, 2009). Such compensation may take various forms,

---

<sup>5</sup> Some literature treats distributive justice as partly backward-looking, in the sense that fair allocation of climate burdens and benefits may also reflect historical responsibility and past obligations (Adelman, 2016; Caney, 2018).

<sup>6</sup> However, the literature provides limited guidance on how these contributions should be calculated in practice. It remains unclear whether higher contributions should be marginally greater or significantly larger, and whether they should be proportional or progressively linked to income or national wealth (Davidson, 2021).

including returning an object, providing financial payments, or other remedial measures intended to correct the imbalance created by the wrongful harm (Thornton, 2021). Corrective justice therefore, relies on responsibility-based and fault-based reasoning. Obligations arise from having caused harm rather than from current economic capacity or distributive fairness considerations (Adelman, 2016; McKinnon, 2009).

Within climate justice literature, the Polluter Pays Principle (PPP)<sup>7</sup> represents the most prominent corrective justice principle (e.g., Adelman, 2016; Jagers & Duus-Otterström, 2008; Okereke, 2010). The PPP is primarily framed as a BL, fault-based principle asserting that those responsible for causing climate change should bear the costs of addressing it (Caney, 2005; Shue, 1993). Meaning, responsibility is largely assigned to industrialized countries whose emissions have dominated since the Industrial Revolution (Caney, 2005; Jagers & Duus-Otterström, 2008). However, the PPP can also be interpreted as a FL principle, according to which only current and future polluters<sup>8</sup> must bear the costs associated with their emissions (Shue, 1999).

A related principle is the Beneficiary Pays Principle (BPP), which offers a remedial alternative to the PPP when the original polluter cannot pay, for example, because they are no longer alive (Adelman, 2016; Davidson, 2021). It holds that actors benefitting from past emission-intensive industrialization, through economic or social advantages, should contribute to remedying resulting harms even if they were not directly responsible for producing the emissions themselves (Adelman, 2016; Caney, 2005; Page, 2012). The BPP therefore shifts attention from polluters to those who continue to profit from historical emissions and is primarily understood as a BL responsibility-based principle.

### **3.1.3. CLIMATE DEBT JUSTICE**

Climate debt justice focuses on the unequal use of the global atmospheric commons and resulting climate-related damages (Ciplet, 2017). It argues that wealthy, industrialized countries have accumulated a climate debt through centuries of carbon-intensive development, while countries contributing least to climate change disproportionately suffer its impacts (Ciplet, 2017; Warlenius, 2018). Climate finance is therefore framed not as voluntary aid or benevolent

---

<sup>7</sup> In climate ethics, the PPP is also called the Contributor Pays Principle (Page, 2012).

<sup>8</sup> While Caney (2005) notes that authors such as Henry Shue identify nations as the primary polluters, he also highlights other emitting actors, including individuals, businesses, or institutions. Although this thesis takes a state-centred approach, the analysis section examines how different coalitions define and attribute responsibility to polluters.

support, but as a form of reparation for the overuse of global carbon sinks and the damages caused by it (Ciplet, 2017).

As a sub-category of corrective justice, climate debt is grounded in BL responsibility and the resulting remedial obligations (Adelman, 2016; Khan et al., 2019; Warlenius, 2018). While both theories identify past harms, corrective climate justice covers a broad range of climate harms attributable to specific wrongful acts or omissions, such as emissions causing loss and damage, adaptation failures, or ecosystem disruptions (Adelman, 2016; Thornton, 2021). On the contrary, climate debt only emphasizes the historical overuse of the global atmospheric commons by industrialized nations, demanding rectification through reparations (Warlenius, 2018).

The literature commonly distinguishes between emissions debt<sup>9</sup> and adaptation debt, with the latter being particularly relevant for analyzing paying principles. Adaptation debt refers to the compensation – often through financial transfers – arising from the additional adaptation and L&D costs imposed on developing countries through climate change (Ciplet, 2017; Khan et al., 2019; Warlenius, 2018). Important hereby is that climate finance “mechanisms should, thus, be designed” (Dafermos, 2025, p. 8) to reduce rather than reproduce debt burdens in vulnerable countries (Dafermos, 2025).

An important, though barely discussed, principle within climate debt justice is the User Pays Principle (UPP)<sup>10</sup>. Unlike the Polluter Pays Principle (PPP), which assigns responsibility based on causing harm (Caney, 2005; Shue, 1993), the UPP focuses on the disproportionate use of a shared global resource. It holds that those who have made extensive use of public environmental goods – such as the atmosphere’s absorptive capacity - should bear the costs of that use (OECD, 1995; Parikh, 1993). While both principles address emissions, they rest on distinct normative foundations. The PPP conceptualises emissions as pollution (“environmental quality”) that generates harm and therefore invokes corrective justice, requiring those responsible for damage to compensate affected parties (Khan et al., 2019; Parikh, 1993). In contrast, the UPP treats emissions primarily as the appropriation of limited environmental or atmospheric space, thereby framing responsibility in terms of unequal use of a global commons (Parikh, 1993).

---

<sup>9</sup> Emissions debt which requires wealthy nations that have utilized the vast majority of the planet’s capacity to absorb greenhouse gases to fuel their own industrialization to drastically reduce emissions to levels below their fair share to “free up” space and repair the South (Gardiner, 2004; M. Khan et al., 2019; Warlenius, 2018).

<sup>10</sup> The UPP stems from the economic and scientific research area. It is often used to defend national park entrance fees or the maintenance of global commons, such as the rainforest (OECD, 1995).

This distinction is particularly relevant for climate debt justice, where the central claim is not merely that industrialised countries caused climate harm, but that they have overused the atmospheric commons, thereby incurring a debt toward those who have used it less.

### **3.2. FAULT-BASED AND NON-FAULT-BASED PRINCIPLES**

The previously introduced 2×2 justice matrix allows to clearly distinguish between different climate justice theories. To further differentiate the paying principles underlying these theories, this thesis follows Shue's (1993) distinction between fault-based (FB) and non-fault-based (N-FB) principles. This distinction captures whether responsibility for climate finance is justified through the attribution of blame or through considerations independent of fault.

FB principles assign responsibility based on wrongful actions, typically the causation of harm (ibid.). Such framings often involve explicit or implicit blame attribution and may be expressed through critical or accusatory language directed at particular actors.

By contrast, N-FB principles justify responsibility without requiring the identification of wrongdoing. N-FB reasoning therefore shifts the focus from who caused the problem and more to who is currently able to contribute to addressing it (ibid.). These framings generally avoid blame attribution and are more frequently articulated through cooperative or encouraging language.

Although climate justice theories and paying principles are analytically distinct, they frequently overlap in practice. Actors may adopt cross-cutting positions, for example, by advocating a fair distribution of climate finance while simultaneously assigning responsibility primarily to historical emitters, or by claiming that countries benefiting from historical emissions now possess a greater ability to pay. Moreover, the same principle can be framed differently by different actors, either as fault-based or non-fault-based, depending on the political objective pursued in negotiations.

## **4. ANALYTICAL FRAMEWORK**

Building on the climate justice theories and paying principles discussed above, this thesis develops a deductive analytical framework to identify justice framings within the analysed documents. While previous studies have applied broader justice categories such as cosmopolitanism, libertarianism, or liberal egalitarianism (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024), no existing framework systematically combines distributive, corrective, and climate debt justice in the context of climate finance negotiations. The framework therefore is built based on the theoretical discussion and specifies the indicators expected for each justice frame.

Distributive climate justice focuses on the equitable allocation of burdens and benefits, particularly regarding vulnerable countries (Chaplain, 2025; Khan et al., 2019; Rawls, 1971). Consequently, distributive framings are expected to include references to “equity”, “fairness”, and “equitable allocation”. The APP, which embodies the FL N-FB principle of distributive climate justice, ensures that different capabilities and circumstances of each actor are taken into account (Moss, 2009; Shue, 1999). Claims that climate finance obligations should reflect states’ economic capacities or prioritise the needs of the most vulnerable are therefore coded as distributive justice.

Corrective climate justice primarily focuses on rectifying wrongful losses and harms caused by climate change (Okereke, 2010; Thornton, 2021). Attributes like “compensation”, “rectification”, “restoration”, “fault”, or “wrongs” are therefore associated with corrective justice. The FL PPP is reflected in claims that current and future emitters should provide climate finance. By contrast, backward-looking corrective justice will specifically emphasize “historical emissions” and “past pollution”, making historical high emitting countries responsible for financially countering the adverse effects of climate change. The BL PPP arguments would eventually claim that historical emitters (industrialized countries), due to their high historical emissions, must provide financial compensation (Adelman, 2016). The BL BPP differs by highlighting that responsibilities for providing climate finance lie with the beneficiaries from that historical pollution (Caney, 2005, 2018). References to historical advantages, accumulated wealth, or present economic positioning derived from past industrialisation would provide evidence of the usage of the BL BPP.

Climate debt justice frames climate finance as owed reparations for the overuse of the atmospheric commons by industrialised countries (Ciplet, 2017; Warlenius, 2018). Keywords would therefore include “reparations”, “owed obligations”, or “debt”. Arguments for climate finance provisions would mainly regard the overuse of the atmospheric space. This argumentation aligns with the BL UPP, which assigns responsibility for climate finance provisions to the user of the environmental capacity (Parikh, 1993).

The complete preliminary framework is provided in the Appendix A.

#### **4.1. THEORETICAL EXPECTATIONS**

Building on the theoretical framework, this section outlines expectations regarding the use of climate justice frames across the three coalitions under analysis. Climate actors rarely rely on a single justice framework; instead, they strategically combine different framings depending on

the issue area and political objectives (e.g., Calliari, 2018; Khan et al., 2019; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). The analysis therefore, seeks to identify which climate justice theories and paying principles dominate each coalition's discourse and which are ultimately reflected in the final decision document. These expectations are derived from existing literature on climate negotiations.

Previous research on UNFCCC negotiations across adaptation, mitigation, or L&D consistently identifies distinct justice framings among actor groups. The AOSIS has strongly advocated for compensation, frequently drawing on corrective justice (Calliari, 2018). They have been one of the most dominant actors calling for reparations in regard to the owed climate debt (Khan et al., 2019; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). At the same time, the coalition also employs distributive justice through references to vulnerability and need (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). Accordingly, the AOSIS is expected to rely primarily on corrective and climate debt framings, complemented by need-based distributive arguments.

The LMDC are commonly associated with a strong emphasis on the historical responsibility of developed countries, reflecting a BL interpretation of the PPP (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). Some studies also identify climate debt narratives among LMDC members such as Pakistan and Malaysia (Halkyer, 2021; Hijrah & Valiantien, 2026). The analysis therefore, expects the LMDC to rely predominantly on BL responsibility claims, with additional references to climate debt.

In contrast, the EU has generally avoided explicit references to compensation or liability in climate negotiations (Calliari, 2018). Instead, it emphasises burden-sharing approaches grounded in distributive justice, considering the needs of the most vulnerable (Hijrah & Valiantien, 2026). This aligns with a broader liberal-egalitarian perspective that prioritises fairness in opportunity rather than corrective claims (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). The EU is therefore expected to prioritise distributive justice while largely avoiding corrective and climate debt framings.

## **5. METHODS AND DATA**

The following section outlines the research design and explains the methods and data used in the analysis.



## 5.1. RESEARCH DESIGN

The analysis compares submissions from three UNFCCC coalitions – the EU, AOSIS, and LMDC – to assess which paying principles, and corresponding climate justice framings, they employ in debates surrounding the NCQG.

The case selection follows a purposive most-different design, as the coalitions represent politically and economically distinct actor groups within the UNFCCC. The EU represents industrialised, high-income countries (Metreau et al., 2025), characterised by high historical and current emissions (Crippa et al., 2025) and a leading role in climate finance provisions (SEKK Development, n.d.). Most EU member states also face comparatively low levels of climate vulnerability (Adil et al., 2025). In contrast, the AOSIS consists of highly climate-vulnerable states, many of which are lower- or upper-middle-income countries (IPCC, 1990; Metreau et al., 2025; UNFCCC, 1992) that receive limited shares of global climate finance (Ciplet et al., 2022; Islam, 2022) despite facing disproportionately high adaptation and L&D costs. These burdens frequently contribute to high public debt levels (Brownbridge & Canagarajah, 2024). The LMDC include emerging economies, such as India, China, and Saudi Arabia, that have become major emitters but are not formally obligated under the Paris Agreement to provide climate finance (Crippa et al., 2025; Halkyer, 2021; Art. 9.1 f. PA). Coalition member states are listed in the Appendix B.

These differences in economic capacity, emission profiles, and climate vulnerability enable a systematic comparison of coalition-specific justice framings within the same institutional setting.

The UNFCCC constitutes the central framework for international climate governance and the primary arena for negotiating climate justice claims (Betsill et al., 2015; Okereke & Coventry, 2016).<sup>11</sup> It is regarded as “the only body that can deliver a comprehensive, legally binding international treaty” (Eckersley, 2012, p. 40). These characteristics make the UNFCCC framework suitable for analysing climate justice framings of UNFCCC member coalitions in regard to a new climate finance goal. Within this framework, COPs serve as the key decision-making platform (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024; UNFCCC, n.d.a), making them relevant for analysing climate justice positions (Chaplain, 2025; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024). Since COP29 was expected to finalise the NCQG (UNFCCC, 2024a), submissions from this process provide

---

<sup>11</sup> Nevertheless, also “transnational, sub-state and private climate governance” (Okereke & Coventry, 2016, p.835) influences and provides differing views of the climate justice debate.

important insights into coalitions's framing of climate finance. The final decision document additionally allows to identify which framings ultimately prevailed.

To capture the full range of NCQG negotiation dynamics, the analysis includes submissions from preparatory processes under the Conference of the Parties serving as the meeting of the Parties to the Paris Agreement (CMA), particularly via the Ad Hoc Work Programmes (AHWP) and technical expert dialogues (TEDs) initiated in 2022 (UNFCCC, n.d.c). Together, these documents provide a comprehensive basis for analysing coalition-specific climate justice framings in the development of the NCQG.

## **5.2. METHOD**

This thesis applies a qualitative frame analysis to examine how coalitions within the UNFCCC construct and justify the provision of fair climate finance in negotiations on the NCQG. The objective is to identify which climate justice frames dominate the debate and which are ultimately reflected in the final agreement.

Frame analysis is grounded in social constructivist approaches, which understand (political) reality as socially constructed through interpretation and shared meaning-making (Vogler, 2016). Frames function as interpretive structures that emphasise certain aspects of reality while downplaying others (Entman, 1993; Goffman, 1974), thereby shaping political narratives and legitimising specific policy positions (Bolsen & Shapiro, 2018). Actors, therefore, do not simply reproduce existing ideas, but actively construct meaning in ways to support their strategic objectives (Snow & Byrd, 2007; Vanhala & Hestbaek, 2016). This makes frame analysis particularly suitable for examining international climate negotiations, where policy outcomes depend strongly on how issues are framed (Béland, 2009). Analysing these frames helps uncover the normative assumptions that shape policy change (Vanhala & Hestbaek, 2016) and provides insight into why certain justice claims prevail in the final NCQG agreement.

To complement the qualitative analysis, Pearson's chi-square tests of independence are conducted using IBM SPSS Statistics, to assess whether differences in frame usage across coalitions are statistically significant. The analysis focuses specifically on variation in the use of climate justice theories and FB versus N-FB paying principles.<sup>12</sup> Accordingly, 3×k contingency tables (coalitions × theories/FB vs. N-FB principles) are used. Statistical significance follows conventional social science thresholds at the 5% level, with higher

---

<sup>12</sup> The statistical significance of the use of paying principle across different coalitions cannot be tested with the chi-square test, as some actors refer to specific principles only once or not at all. This results in expected cell values below five, thereby violating a basic condition of the chi-square test (Gaunt et al., 2017).

significance reporting at the 1% and 0.1% levels (Sirkin, 2006). The Standardized residuals exceeding  $\pm 2^{13}$  are interpreted as meaningful deviations from expected distributions (Agresti, 1996). To assess the strength of associations Cramer's V is additionally calculated (McHugh, 2013). According to Cohen (1977) the interpretation of the effect size depends on the structure of the contingency tables. For the commonly used 2x2 tables, benchmark values are set at  $w = .10$  (small),  $.30$  (medium), and  $.50$  (large). For larger tables, these thresholds are adjusted by dividing them by  $\frac{w}{\sqrt{\min(r-1)(k-1)}}$  (ibid.). Consequently, the benchmark remains unchanged for the 3x2 contingency table, whereas adjusted thresholds of approximately  $.07$ ,  $.21$ , and  $.35$  apply to the 3x3 contingency table (Appendix E3).

Because frame analysis has rarely been applied to climate justice (Biermann & Kalfagianni, 2020; Lefstad & Paavola, 2024), and even less frequently to climate finance negotiations (Ciplet, 2017), this study develops a theory-driven analytical framework based on the analytical chapter and refined throughout the analysis (Table 1). The argumentations and target terms provided an overview of which content could be assigned to which frame (Appendix D). Coalition submissions were systematically coded in NVivo using a combined deductive-inductive approach. Initial codes were derived from the theories, while additional codes were added where new patterns emerged during analysis (Forman & Damschroder, 2007). This approach enabled both systematic theory testing and sensitivity to unexpected discursive framings. Documents were manually coded at sentence or paragraph level, depending on the thematic coherence. After identifying the frame to which each sentence or paragraph belonged, the language used was judged as either FB or N-FB. Where passages reflected one or more justice frames, all relevant codes were assigned.

### 5.3. DATA

All coalition submissions were collected from official UNFCCC sources. The initial step involved compiling all submissions related to the NCQG from the UNFCCC website, including inputs to the Ad Hoc Work Programme (AHWP) and Technical Expert Dialogues (TEDs) between 2022 and 2024. These documents were then filtered to include only submissions from the EU, AOSIS, and LMDC.

The number of submissions varied across coalitions. While the EU and LMDC submitted eight and seven documents respectively, the AOSIS submitted only three. To improve comparability, additional submissions from India (LMDC) and Vanuatu (AOSIS) were included, as both are

---

<sup>13</sup> The  $\pm 2$  round up of the threshold approximates the 95% confidence interval boundary ( $\pm 1.96$ ), and is widely used in the chi-square residual analysis.

considered representative members of their coalitions.<sup>14</sup> This added three LMDC and two AOSIS documents. No additional EU submissions were included, as no individual member state submitted separate inputs.

All documents were cross-checked through the UNFCCC submission portal, with a primary focus on CMA4-6 sessions. Keyword searches for “New Collective Quantified Goal” and “NCQG” were conducted to ensure completeness. Additional UNFCCC sessions (SBSTA, SBI, CMP) from 2022–2024 were reviewed, but no further relevant documents were identified. COP29 submissions and opening statements were also screened and included where they address the NCQG; for AOSIS, draft closing statements were additionally considered. One EU submission was excluded because it was only available in French, while the analysis is limited to English-language documents. Finally, the NCQG decision text, Decision 1/CMA.6, was analysed.

In total, the dataset comprised 32 documents: 9 from the AOSIS, 10 from the EU, 12 from the LMDC, and the final decision document. All analyzed sources are listed in Appendix C and cited as empirical sources using the coalition’s name and upload date abbreviation (e.g., AOSIS Mar 2022).

## 6. ANALYSIS

This section presents the results of the analysis of how climate justice frames and their corresponding paying principles are employed by each coalition in the context of the NCQG. It begins by outlining the inductive frames identified in the submission analysis, and then examines the general attribution of responsibility for climate finance provision (contributor base), which provides essential context for interpreting the paying principles. The section then analyses the use of paying principles and justice theories by the EU, AOSIS, and LMDC. Table 1 summarises the overall frame categories, while a more detailed coding framework is provided in Appendix D. Although all three coalitions draw on the full range of climate justice frames, their emphasis differs considerably. Variation also occurs within individual theories, where paying principles are applied differently.

---

<sup>14</sup> India has been regarded as a core member of the LMDC and consistently supports the coalition’s demands for differentiation in international negotiations (Sengupta, 2019). Its representative role is further reflected by the fact that the current LMDC spokesperson is the Indian representative Ms Suman Rawat (UNFCCC, 2026). Vanuatu is recognised “as the founding chair of the [...] AOSIS [and] first introduced the concept of [L&D] (Bartlett, 2026, p. 4), which remains central to AOSIS advocacy (Calliari, 2018). Moreover, Vanuatu faces the same key economic and geographic vulnerabilities to climate change as other AOSIS members (Bartlett, 2026).

| Theory                              | Paying Principles           |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>Distributive climate justice</b> | FL N-FB APP                 |
|                                     | FL N-FB Global effort       |
|                                     | FL N-FB A                   |
|                                     | FL N-FB Equity and Fairness |
| <b>Corrective climate justice</b>   | FL FB PPP                   |
|                                     | BL FB PPP                   |
|                                     | BL FB BPP                   |
|                                     | BL FB Lessons learned       |
|                                     | BL N-FB Lessons learned     |
| <b>Climate debt justice</b>         | BL FB UPP                   |
|                                     | BL FB Debt burdens          |
|                                     | BL N-FB Debt burdens        |

Table 1. Overview of climate justice theories with the corresponding paying principles

## 6.1. INDUCTIVE FRAMES

The analysis identifies several inductively derived frames that can be situated within the broader climate justice theories outlined above. These frames are introduced below and examined in greater detail in the coalition-specific analysis.

### 6.1.1. GLOBAL EFFORT

The global effort principle frames climate finance mobilisation as a shared responsibility extending across all parties and sectors. While the Paris Agreement already describes climate finance as a global effort led by developed countries (Art. 3), this framing is used in the NCQG negotiations more specifically to advocate a broader contributor base, including parties and private sector actors with evolving capabilities (EU Jan 2024; Aug 2024). The frame aligns with distributive climate justice, as it emphasises the equitable allocation of responsibilities among all actors according to their present circumstances and capabilities (Bastos & Duleba, 2025; Jagers & Duus-Otterström, 2008).

### 6.1.2. SOLIDARITY

The solidarity frame presents climate finance as collective support for the most vulnerable, rather than a legal obligation (EU Aug 2023; Nov 2024). It emphasises cooperation and shared responsibility in addressing climate impacts and can therefore be associated with distributive climate justice, particularly its focus on supporting the least advantaged actors (Khan et al., 2019).

### 6.1.3. EQUITY AND FAIRNESS

The equity and fairness frame stresses the need for just burden-sharing in climate finance provision, particularly among developed countries (AOSIS Jun 2024; LMDC Aug 2024). This

includes proposals for ex-ante mechanisms defining countries' "fair shares" (LMDC Mar 2022; Aug 2024). The frame reflects distributive climate justice through its focus on equitable allocation of responsibilities and resources (Bastos & Duleba, 2025).

#### **6.1.4. LESSONS LEARNED**

The lessons learned frame refers to shortcomings in previous climate finance arrangements, especially the USD 100 billion goal, and argues that these experiences should inform the design of the NCQG. References commonly address unmet commitments, accounting methods, and insufficient recognition of developing countries' needs (AOSIS Jun 2024). This frame aligns with corrective climate justice as it focuses on addressing past wrongdoings in order to rectify or improve them (Khan et al., 2019; Okereke, 2010).

#### **6.1.5. DEBT BURDENS**

Debt burdens constitute a central concern in the negotiations, particularly regarding whether climate finance alleviates or reinforces financial pressure in recipient countries. Discussions focus on the accessibility and quality of finance, including the use of loans versus grants and debt-related conditionalities (EU Aug 2024; AOSIS Jun 2024; LMDC Aug 2024). This frame is closely linked to climate debt justice, which argues that the debts must not only be repaid but also delivered in forms that do not impose additional burdens on already vulnerable economies (Dafermos, 2025).

### **6.2. CONTRIBUTOR BASE**

Paying principles provide the normative justification for why actors are expected to provide climate finance (Massenberg, 2021). Before analysing these principles, it is necessary to identify which actors are considered responsible for providing finance. Although the contributor base is not treated as an inductive frame, it forms the foundation of debates over climate finance obligations. Coalition submissions therefore allow a reconstruction of which actors each coalition recognises as contributors.

#### **6.2.1. ART. 9 PA CONTRIBUTOR BASE**

The legal basis for climate finance provisions is established in Article 9 of the Paris Agreement. It obliges developed countries to provide financial resources to developing countries (Art. 9.1), primarily through public finance (Ferreira, 2018). Other parties are encouraged, but not required, to contribute voluntarily (Art. 9.2). In addition, developed countries are expected to mobilise further finance from alternative sources (Art. 9.3), including the private sector

(Ferreira, 2018). Overall, the PA assigns binding responsibility to developed countries, while leaving contributions from other actors voluntary.

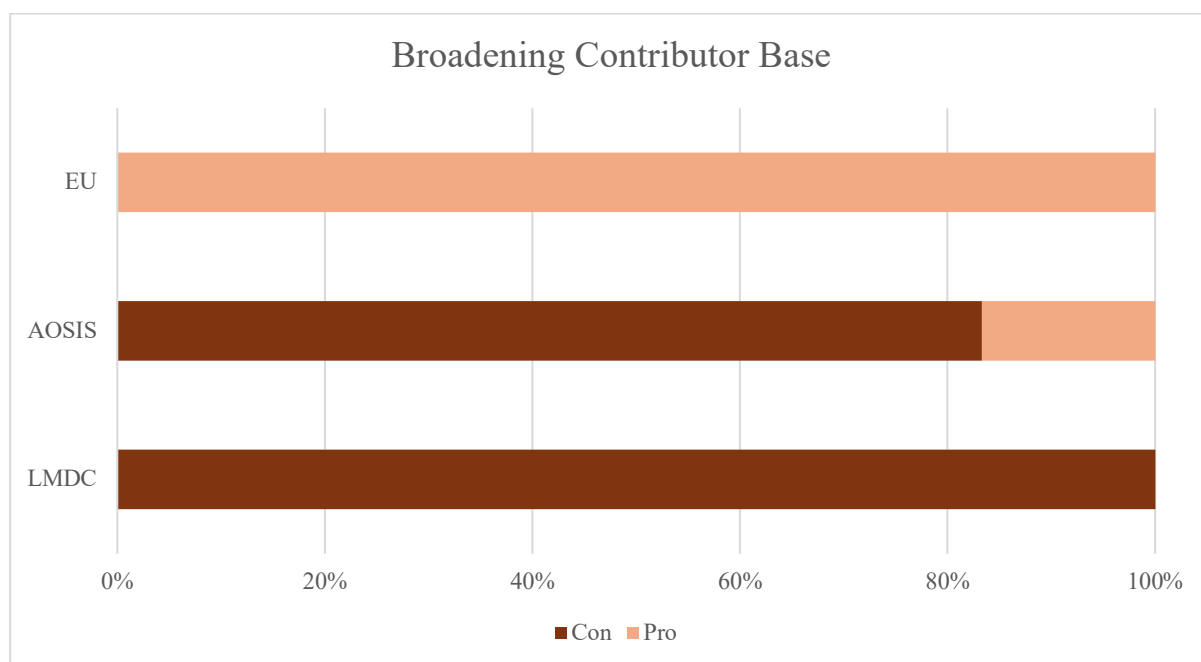


Figure 2. Coalition’s opinion regarding broadening the contributor base.

### 6.2.2. RESULTS CONTRIBUTOR BASE

In the NCQG negotiations, the question of who should contribute to climate finance has re-emerged as a central point of contention. Figure 2 illustrates each coalition’s position on broadening the contributor base, measured by the share of references supporting or opposing expansion.

As shown in Figure 2, the EU consistently supports expanding the contributor base, favouring it in all coded references. Its submissions advocate a “broader (international) finance landscape” (EU Mar 2022; May 2024; Aug 2024) and explicitly include “South-South” financial flows (EU Feb 2023; May 2024). This position implies that not only developed countries, but also economically capable developing countries should contribute to climate finance (EU May 2024). At the same time, the EU reiterates its commitment to maintaining a leading role in climate finance provision (EU Oct 2022; May 2023).

In contrast, the AOSIS predominantly opposes expanding the contributor base. As reflected in Figure 2, around 83% of its references reject a broader contributor base, while only a small minority support it. The AOSIS consistently emphasises that developed countries remain primarily responsible for providing climate finance under existing agreements (AOSIS Jun

2022; Feb 2024; Nov 2024). Although Vanuatu (Mar 2023) briefly refers to a potentially wider contributor base, no additional contributors are specified.

Figure 2 exhibits that the LMDC most strongly reject an expanded contributor base, opposing it in all coded references. Some submissions dismiss the discussion altogether (LMDC May 2023), while others, like the AOSIS, repeatedly stress that climate finance obligations rest with developed countries under existing agreements (e.g., India Feb 2024; LMDC n/a).

Overall, the findings reveal a clear divide between the EU, which advocates a broader and more inclusive contributor base, and the AOSIS and LMDC, which maintain a strict interpretation centred on developed countries’ obligations. This division forms the basis for the following analysis of paying principles and climate justice framings.

### 6.3. THE EU

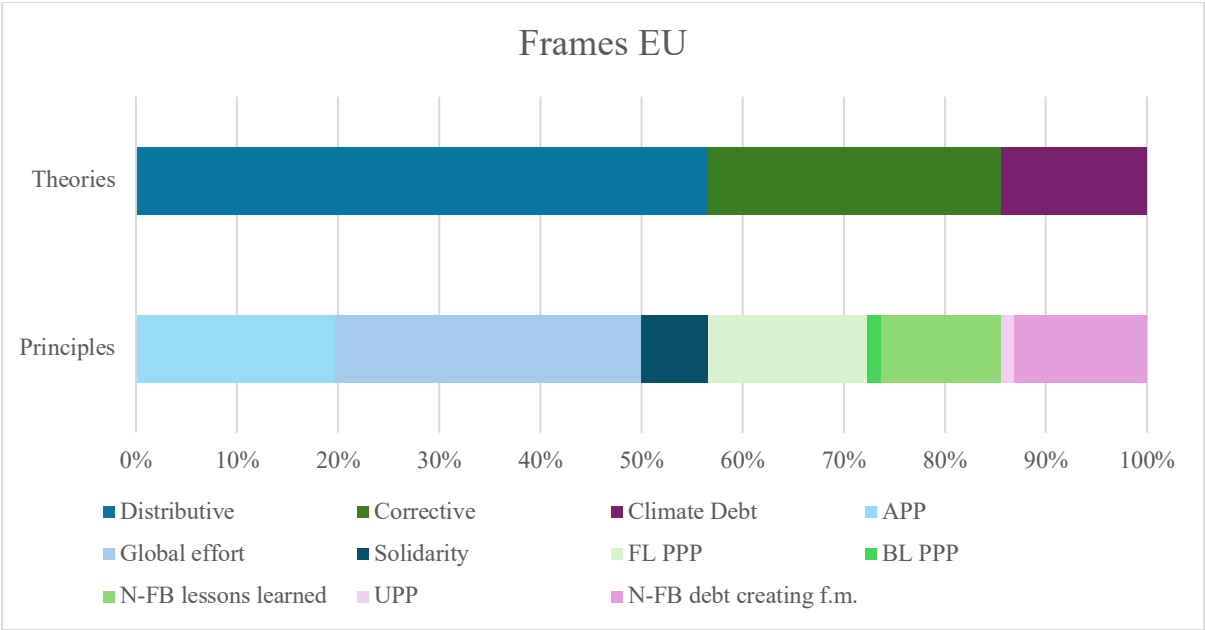


Figure 3. Frames used by the EU

In the NCQG negotiations, the EU makes extensive use of climate justice frames, drawing on principles across distributive, corrective, and climate debt justice. Though its position is primarily rooted in distributive climate justice.

Within the distributive framework, the dominant principle is global effort. Across several submissions, the EU argues that achieving the Paris Agreement goals requires contributions from a broad range of actors (EU Aug 2024). It repeatedly stresses that climate finance mobilisation is not limited to developed countries, but constitutes a shared global responsibility, encouraging broader participation, including “South-South financial flows” (EU Feb 2023). The EU also emphasises the mobilisation of private finance (EU May 2023), arguing that



“sufficient global capital” (EU Aug 2024) exists to meet climate finance needs. At the same time, it consistently reaffirms that “developed country Parties [will] continue to take the lead” (EU May 2023) in providing climate finance, particularly in supporting vulnerable states (ibid.). The global effort principle therefore serves to justify a broader contributor base, while claiming that other parties than the developed ones “that are in the position to do so should also provide financial support” (APP) (EU Mar 2022).

The second key distributive principle is the APP. The EU repeatedly argues that global economic realities have changed and that some countries now possess the financial capacities to contribute to climate finance (EU May 2024). Consequently, the NCQG should reflect these evolving capabilities, both in terms of contributor responsibilities and the overall scale of finance mobilised (ibid.). These references are therefore used to support expanding the contributor base beyond the traditional developed country group (EU Jul 2023).

Closely linked to these arguments, the EU also invokes solidarity as a distributive principle, framing climate finance as support for the most vulnerable countries and a fair allocation of resources according to need (EU Nov 2024).

Corrective climate justice represents the second major justice frame in the EU’s submissions, although it appears less frequently than distributive arguments. It is mainly expressed through a FL interpretation of the PPP. While the EU briefly acknowledges historical responsibilities (BL PPP) in determining the NCQG quantum (EU May 2023), it primarily emphasises that current and future emitters should bear responsibility for financing climate action (EU Mar 2022; Aug 2024; Nov 2024). This includes references to high-emitting private sectors, such as fossil fuel industries, and policy instruments like carbon pricing (EU Aug 2024). These arguments are often combined with considerations of economic capacity, linking the PPP with the APP (EU Aug 2024; May 2024).

Furthermore, the EU also refers to the lessons learned frame of corrective justice regarding past shortcomings, particularly of the USD 100 billion goal. This framing remains largely N-FB (EU Nov 2023), recognizing past challenges, while responsibility is not attributed to specific actors. Instead, the EU focuses on “improv[ing] efforts” (EU Mar 2022), “incorporating” (EU Nov 2023) or “building on [...] experience” (EU Oct 2022), using language in an encouraging forward-looking tone. Proposals such as shifting towards more flexible, bottom-up approaches to climate finance illustrate this orientation (ibid.).

Climate debt justice appears only marginally and mainly in relation to the quality of finance. The EU acknowledges that developing countries face significant financial constraints and

therefore highlights the importance of debt-avoiding mechanisms, including concessional finance and debt swaps (EU Mar 2022; May 2024).

It also briefly invokes the UPP by stating “that all Parties in terms of cumulative emissions in the atmosphere” (EU Aug 2024) should contribute to climate finance. In doing so, responsibility is extended beyond developed countries to all major emitters, reflecting a combination of UPP and APP reasoning.

Overall, the EU’s framing is characterised by a strong reliance on distributive climate justice and predominantly N-FB paying principles, which support a broader contributor base.

### 6.4. THE AOSIS

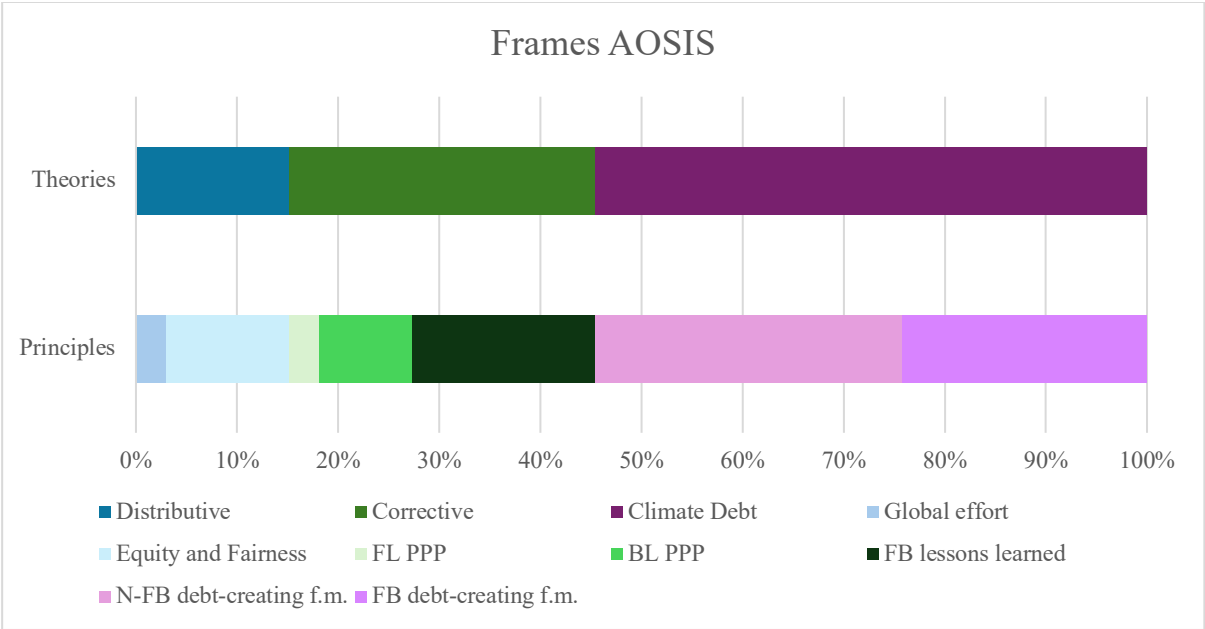


Figure 4. Frames used by the AOSIS

In contrast to the EU, the AOSIS primarily frames climate finance through climate debt justice. A particular emphasis within this frame lies on debt burdens, combining both FB and N-FB approaches, though the latter is slightly more prominent.

In its N-FB framing, the AOSIS consistently emphasises the need to prevent additional financial burdens on developing countries. The AOSIS repeatedly highlights the importance of debt sustainability (AOSIS Mar 2022), taking existing debt levels into account (AOSIS Jun 2024), and the need to avoid climate finance from creating further financial strains (Vanuatu Mar 2023). Rather than assigning blame to specific actors, these arguments focus on the structural vulnerabilities of developing countries, particularly SIDS. The AOSIS repeatedly stresses the unique circumstances and fiscal constraints of these states, reinforcing a need-based argument,

thereby aligning with a N-FB logic (AOSIS Jun 2024; Nov 2024; AOSIS & LDC Jun 2024). At the same time, the AOSIS also adopts FB debt burden framings. Hereby, they criticise the difficulties in accessing climate finance (AOSIS Nov 2024), the disproportionate burdens imposed by existing mechanisms, and “perverse incentives” within the financial architecture (AOSIS Jun 2024). In these instances, the AOSIS explicitly calls on developed countries to address these “systemic inequities” (AOSIS Jun 2024), thereby assigning responsibility to specific countries – developed countries. This combination of N-FB and FB framing allows the AOSIS to stress both structural vulnerability and responsibility for existing injustices.

Corrective climate justice forms a second major strand. Unlike the EU’s mainly N-FB lessons learned approach, the AOSIS adopts a more FB perspective. It frequently refers to shortcomings of previous climate finance commitments, including insufficient recognition of developing countries’ needs, the creation of disproportionate burdens, and the failure to fully meet agreed targets (AOSIS Jun 2024). While this framing presents a critical tone, responsibility is not explicitly attributed to specific actors.

In addition, the AOSIS employs the BL PPP. It links climate finance obligations to historical emissions, arguing that developed countries should bear primary responsibility due to their disproportionate contribution to climate change (AOSIS Jun 2024). References to “larger emitters”, such as G20 countries, allows for an understanding of both BL and FL PPP, including historical and current emitters.

Distributive climate justice appears less frequently and is mainly expressed through equity and fairness claims. The AOSIS calls for “fair, just and equitable burden sharing amongst developed country Parties” (AOSIS Jun 2024), reinforcing the view that developed countries should remain the main providers of climate finance. These arguments are occasionally complemented with the BL PPP, linking distributive to corrective elements (ibid.)

Only marginally does the AOSIS frame climate finance as a broader global effort involving all countries in order to protect SIDS (AOSIS Nov 2024).

Overall, the AOSIS’s framing is dominated by climate debt justice, combining both N-FB and FB paying principles.

6.5. THE LMDC

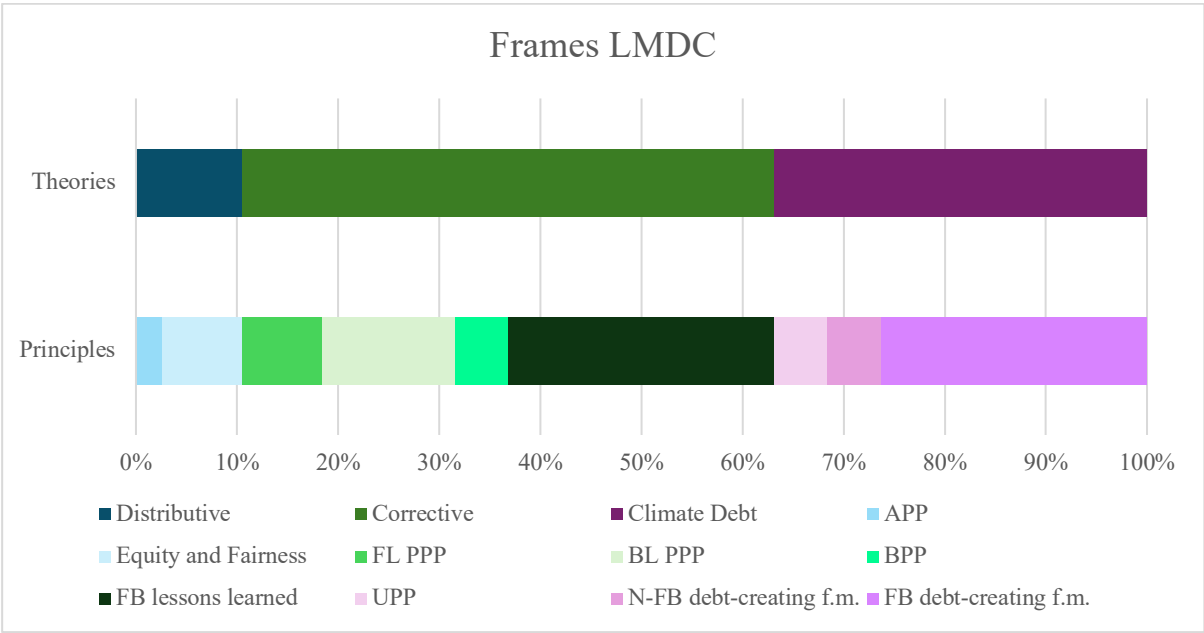


Figure 5. Frames used by the LMDC

Within the LMDC submissions, corrective climate justice is the dominant framing, strongly shaped by FB interpretations. A central element is the lessons learned frame, which is expressed in explicitly critical terms. The LMDC repeatedly assign responsibility for the provision of climate finance to developed countries (LMDC May 2023; Aug 2024) and employs language that highlights unfulfilled commitments, “past shortcomings”, and the “insufficiency and inadequacy” of existing climate finance arrangements, while assigning responsibility to developed countries (India Feb 2024; LMDC Mar 2022; Feb 2024). These references go beyond description by demanding that developed countries rectify previous failures (India Feb 2024). A recurring issue within this framing is the absence of a universally agreed-upon definition of climate finance. Several submissions frame this as a key reason for insufficient delivery and accountability, consequently stressing the need to establish a common definition as part of the NCQG negotiations (India Feb 2022; LMDC 2023).

Corrective framing is also closely linked to the BL PPP. LMDC submissions consistently connect climate finance obligations to the historical emissions of developed countries, while stressing that developing countries still require carbon space for economic development (India Feb 2022; LMDC Nov 2024). Compared to this strong emphasis on historical responsibility, FL interpretations of the PPP appear only marginally, mainly in Indian submissions (Feb 2022; 2023). While one reference explicitly mentions the PPP, leaving undefined whether in regard to current or past emissions, it assigns this responsibility to developed countries (India Feb 2023). While yet another mentioning from the same submission proposes general country

provisions based on “current emission levels”, broadening the spectrum to all high-emitting countries (India Feb 2022).

The BPP appears indirectly in India’s submission (Feb 2022) with the proposal that developed countries should contribute 0.5% of their GDP, implicitly linking current wealth to carbon-intensive development.

Climate debt justice forms the second major frame. Similar to the AOSIS, the LMDC focus primarily on debt burdens, but with a stronger FB emphasis. They highlight the already fragile fiscal position of many developing countries and argue that existing climate finance structures exacerbate these vulnerabilities by increasing debt burdens (LMDC Sep 2023; Mar 2022). This critique is closely tied to calls for reform, particularly the provision of climate finance in the form of public, grant-based, and concessional resources (LMDC Sep 2023; n/a). Responsibility is consistently attributed to developed countries (LMDC Mar 2022; Feb 2023; Sep 2023).

N-FB references to debt burdens appear only marginally and typically in a more implicit manner, stating that “financial support should predominantly be unencumbered” or “avoid[...] debt distress” (India Feb 2022; 2023).

India’s (Feb 2023; 2024) submissions also explicitly invoke the UPP. Here, climate finance is framed as “an obligation of the developed world to the developing world owing to their (developed countries) stock of GHG in the atmosphere” (India, Feb 2022; 2023). This argument reinforces the claim that financial transfers should be provided as grants and on concessional terms.

Distributive climate justice plays only a limited role and is mainly expressed through equity and fairness claims. These arguments emphasise that the burden of providing climate finance should be shared among developed countries (LMDC Aug 2024; n/a) and highlighting that “developing countries already pay more than their fair share” (LMDC Mar 2022).

In some instances, the APP is combined with the PPP, while still making the provision of climate finance the responsibility of developed countries (India Feb 2023).

Overall, the LMDC framing is characterised by a strong reliance on corrective climate justice, predominantly articulated through FB paying principles.

## **6.6. COMPARISON BETWEEN COALITIONS**

Building on the previous analysis, this section compares how the three coalitions employ climate justice frames and related paying principles.

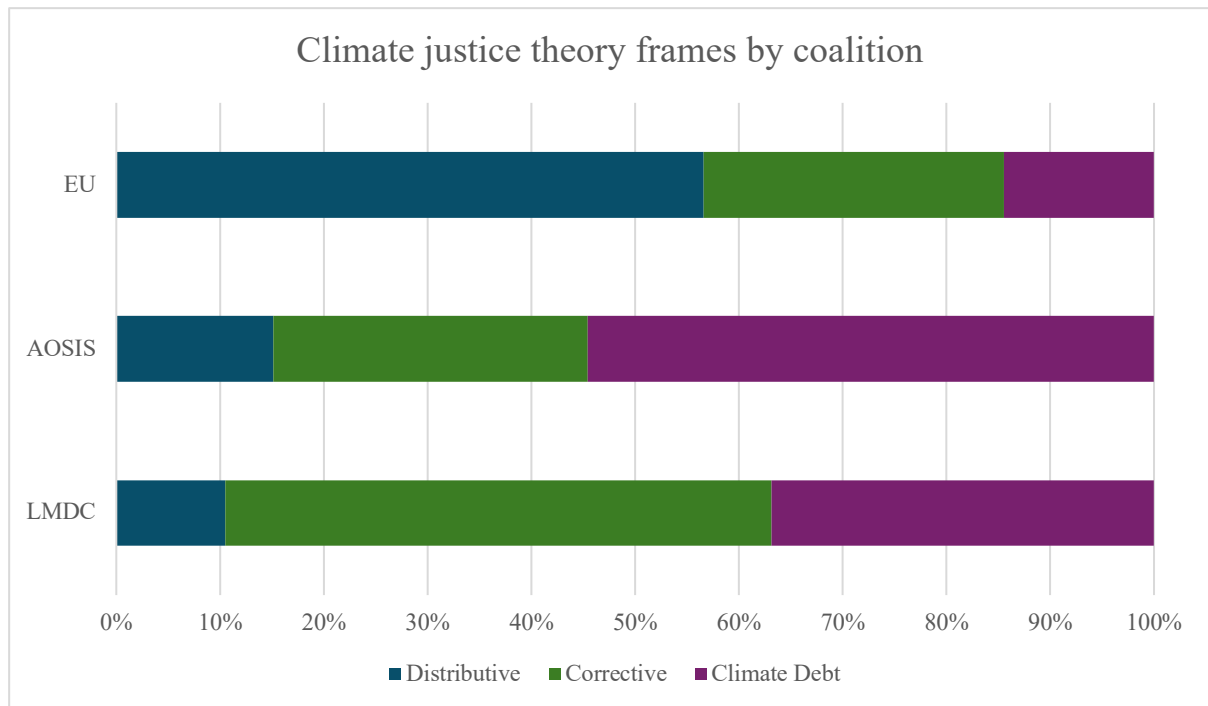


Figure 6. Climate justice theory frames by coalition.

Figure 6 reveals a clear divergence in the use of climate justice theories. Each coalition prioritises a distinct framework. The EU relies predominantly on distributive justice (over 55% of references), AOSIS emphasises climate debt justice (around 50%), and LMDC primarily employ corrective justice (approximately 52%). Both the AOSIS and LMDC concentrate strongly on corrective and climate debt perspectives while making only limited use of distributive arguments (15% and 11% respectively). By contrast, the EU engages only marginally with climate debt justice (around 15%), instead foregrounding distributional considerations.

| Coalition | Distributive Climate Justice | Corrective Climate Justice | Climate Debt Justice |
|-----------|------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|
| EU        | +2.5                         | -.2                        | -2.1                 |
| AOSIS     | -1.5                         | -.8                        | +2.2                 |
| LMDC      | -1.9                         | +1.1                       | +.7                  |

Table 2. Residuals regarding use of climate justice theories across coalitions

Note: Standardized residuals exceeding  $\pm 2$  are interpreted as meaningful deviations.

A chi-square test confirms a highly statistically significant relationship between coalition affiliation and justice theory framing ( $p < .001$ ). Standardized residuals show that the AOSIS employs climate debt justice more frequently than expected (+2.2), while the EU relies significantly more on distributive justice (+2.5) and less on climate debt justice (-2.1). The

LMDC display a less distinctive pattern. Cramer's V indicates a moderate association (around .31) between coalition affiliation and justice theory framing (see Appendix E1).

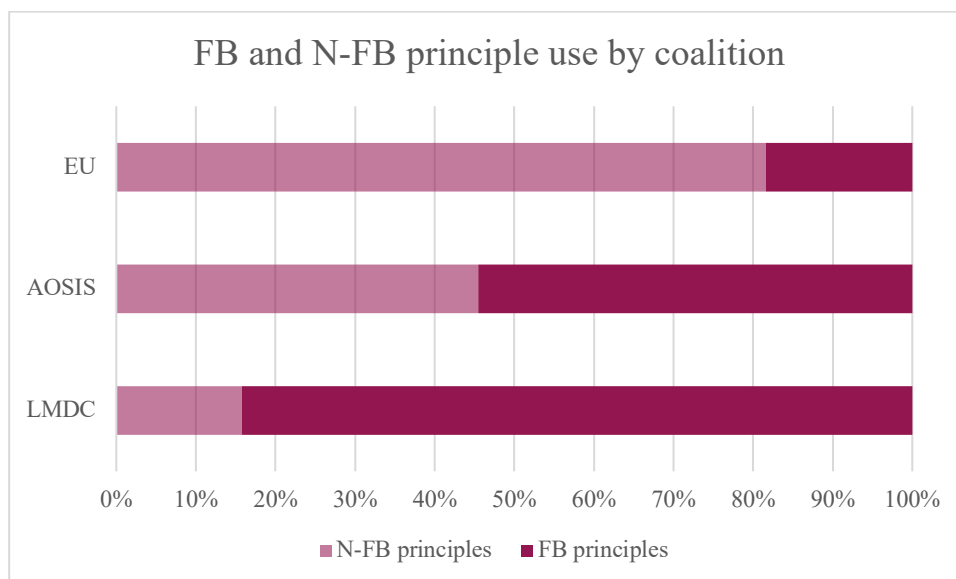


Figure 7. FB and N-FB principle use by coalition.

| Coalition | FB   | N-FB |
|-----------|------|------|
| EU        | -2.8 | +2.5 |
| AOSIS     | +.5  | -0.5 |
| LMDC      | +3.2 | -2.9 |

Table 3. Residuals regarding use of paying principles across coalitions

Note: Standardized residuals exceeding  $\pm 2$  are interpreted as meaningful deviations.

A similarly pronounced divide appears in the use of paying principles (Figure 7). The chi-square test indicates a highly significant relationship between coalition affiliation and the use of FB and N-FB principles ( $p < .001$ ). The EU overwhelmingly relies on N-FB principles, accounting for over 80% of coded principles and occurring significantly more often than expected (+2.5). By contrast, the AOSIS displays a comparatively balanced distribution between FB (approximately 55%) and N-FB principles (around 45%), without statistically significant deviations. The LMDC, in turn, predominantly employ FB principles (around 85%), using significantly more FB principles than expected (+3.2) and fewer N-FB principles (-2.9). Cramer's V ( $= .52$ ) suggest a strong association between coalition affiliation and the use of FB and N-FB principles.

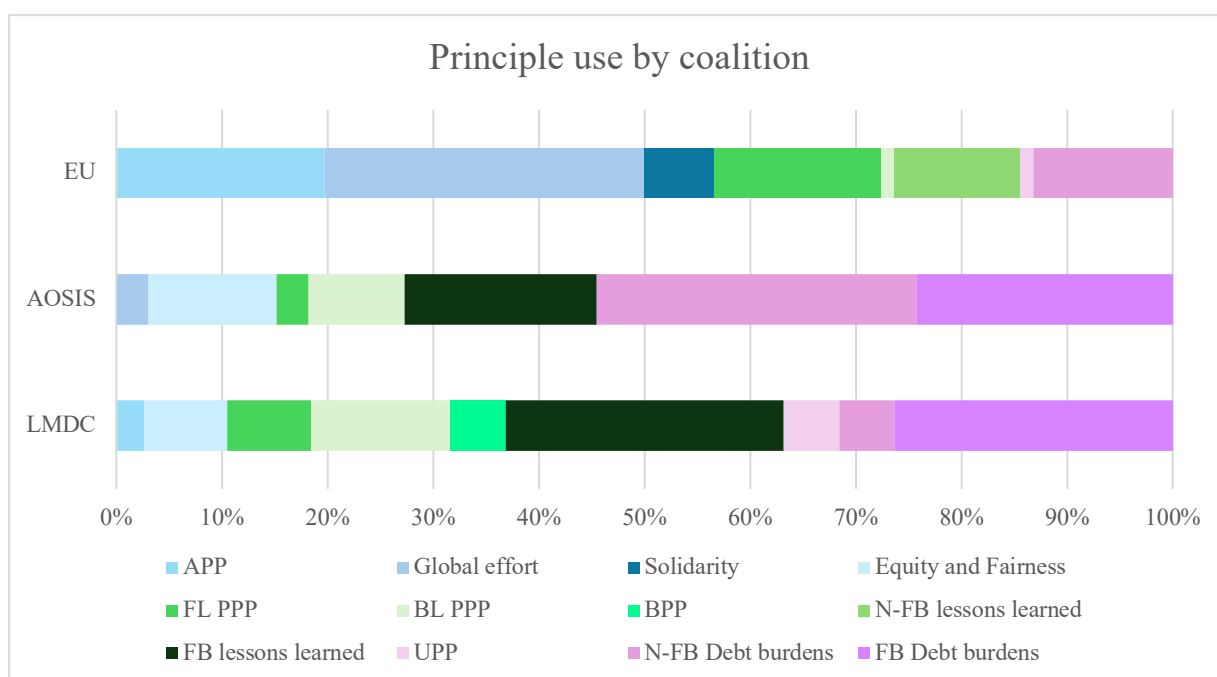


Figure 8. Principle use by coalition.

Figure 8 provides a direct comparison of the use of paying principles across the three coalitions. Several important differences emerge from this comparison. The EU relies mainly on distributive principles, particularly global effort, and is the only coalition invoking the solidarity principle. However, while the EU avoids references to equity and fairness, this principle constitutes the primary distributive framing used by both the AOSIS and LMDC.

Figure 8 shows that FB debt burden arguments appear only in the AOSIS and LMDC submissions, accounting for nearly one quarter of all analysed principles, while it remains absent in the EU's framings.

Also notably, the BPP is exclusively used by the LMDC.

Furthermore, important content-related differences of the paying principles remain.

Although both the AOSIS and LMDC frequently invoke the FB lessons learned principle (see Figure 8) and often refer to past shortcomings, only the LMDC explicitly attribute responsibility to developed countries (India Feb 2024; LMDC Mar 2022; May 2023). The AOSIS, in contrast, never directly assigns blame to a specific actor (AOSIS Jun 2024).

Similarly, as Figure 8 displays, the UPP appears in both the EU and LMDC submissions, but with different meanings. The EU uses it to argue for “evolving [...] responsibilities of all Parties in terms of cumulative emissions in the atmosphere” (EU Aug 2024), thereby supporting a broadened contributor base. Contrary to this, India (Feb 2023; 2024) frames the UPP in



reparative terms, portraying climate finance as a debt owed by developed countries to those that have made limited use of atmospheric resources.

Overall, the comparison reveals a structured divide: the EU advances predominantly distributive and N-FB reasoning, the AOSIS combines climate debt with a balanced use of fault attribution, and the LMDC articulate a strongly FB and corrective justice position.

## 6.7. DECISION 1/CMA.6 – NCQG

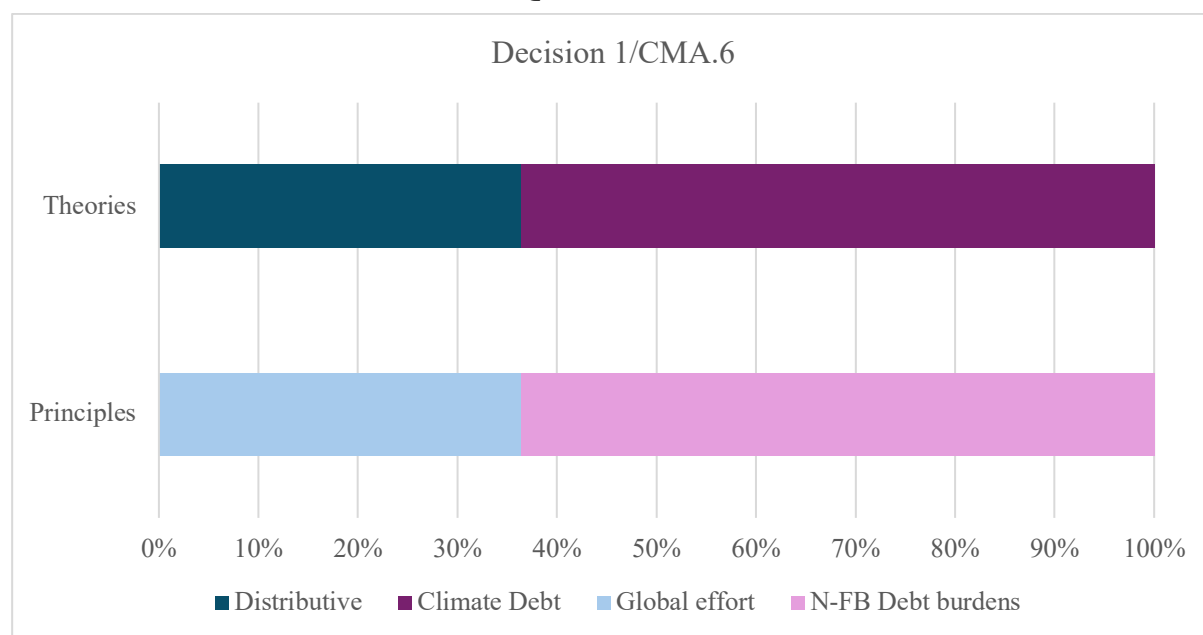


Figure 9. Climate justice theory and principle usage in the final decision document.

Decision 1/CMA.6 represents the final negotiated outcome of the NCQG and reflects the consensus reached among all parties. Figure 9 shows that the decision text primarily incorporates elements of climate debt justice and distributive climate justice, while broader forms of corrective justice remain largely absent. Within these frameworks, one dominant principle emerges in each case.

Figure 9 reflects that the dominant frame in the final decision text is climate debt justice, particularly though the N-FB debt burden principle. The text repeatedly highlights the need to address structural barriers that restrict access to climate finance and contribute to rising debt burdens in developing countries. References to high capital costs, limited fiscal space, and “unsustainable debt levels” emphasise the financial challenges faced by vulnerable countries (para. 6). In response, the text underscores the importance of increasing public, grant-based, and concessional finance (para. 8). However, the language remains encouraging and forward-

looking focusing on recognition, encouragement, and improvement, rather than fault attribution (para. 14; 21; 23 (e) f.).

As Figure 9 illustrates, the second major frame is distributive climate justice, reflected in the principle of global effort. Echoing the EU's position, the decision states that "sufficient global capital" exists to meet climate finance needs, reminding all actors to remove barriers to mobilise it (para. 4). The NCQG establishes a target of mobilising USD 1.3 trillion annually, explicitly referring to contributions from all actors through public and private sources, extending responsibility beyond developed countries alone (para. 7). At the same time, the decision reaffirms that developed countries continue to take the lead in providing climate finance (para. 8). In addition, South-South contributions are also clearly mentioned, though they remain voluntary and supplementary (para. 9).

Overall, the final decision combines climate debt and distributive justice framings, centered on the N-FB principles, debt burdens, and global effort.

## **7. DISCUSSION**

This section discusses the findings in relation to the research questions outlined in the introduction. It further considers the implications of the findings for future climate finance negotiations, reflects the limitations of the study, and identifies potential future research.

### **7.1. USAGE OF CLIMATE JUSTICE THEORIES AND PAYING PRINCIPLES**

Addressing the questions of how UNFCCC parties frame paying obligations under the NCQG and which climate justice logics underpin these positions, the analysis reveals clear differences between the EU, AOSIS, and LMDC regarding both the principles they prioritise and their broader understanding of climate justice. The findings regarding the first sub question demonstrate a pronounced divide between FB and N-FB reasoning, reflecting wider political disagreements over responsibility, liability, and the future architecture of climate finance within the UNFCCC regime.

| <b>Coalition</b> | <b>Theoretical expectation</b>                                                                                                          | <b>Confirmation</b>                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>EU</b>        | The EU is expected to emphasise distributive justice while largely avoiding corrective and climate debt framings.                       | Partly supported.<br><br>The EU primarily uses distributive justice frames, however also frequently uses the FL PPP and highlights N-FB debt burdens in the climate debt justice frame. |
| <b>AOSIS</b>     | The AOSIS is expected to predominantly rely on corrective and climate debt framings, complemented by need-based distributive arguments. | Supported.                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>LMDC</b>      | The LMDC are expected to strongly rely on BL responsibility claims with additional references to climate debt.                          | Supported.                                                                                                                                                                              |

Table 4. Support of theoretical expectations.

The expectation that the EU would primarily emphasise distributive justice while avoiding corrective and climate debt framings is only partly supported. As expected, the EU relies predominantly on distributive (residual = +2.5) and N-FB framings (residual = +2.5), especially the principles of global effort, solidarity, and APP. Its arguments stress collective action, evolving capabilities, and financial contributions from all capable actors (see Figure 3). This aligns with previous research showing that developed countries frame climate finance around cooperation, collective action, and economic growth rather than historical responsibility, compensation, or fault-based liability (FB residuals = -2.8) (Audet, 2013; Okereke & Coventry, 2016). This strong reliance on N-FB reasoning supports the EU's broader aim of expanding the contributor base by shifting attention from historical emissions to present capabilities.

However, the findings also challenge earlier studies suggesting that the EU avoids corrective and climate debt framings altogether (Calliari, 2018; Khan et al., 2019). The EU frequently employs the FL FB PPP of corrective justice, arguing that major current emitters, including emerging economies and private actors, should contribute to climate finance. Rising emissions in countries such as China and India provide the basis for this argument (Crippa et al., 2025). In doing so, the EU reframes responsibility from historical emissions towards present and future contributions to climate change, thereby supporting its objective of broadening climate finance obligations (Okereke & Coventry, 2016).

Although climate debt justice appears less frequently than expected (residual = -2.1), the EU still invokes N-FB debt burden framings, particularly regarding concessional finance and

financial reform. These arguments avoid explicit blame attribution and instead focus on preventing future debt distress and improving financial structures. Rather than invoking reparative justice, these framings reflect the EU's broader understanding of climate finance as a future-oriented collective project and global effort (Audet, 2013).

The expectations regarding the AOSIS are strongly supported. Unlike the EU, the AOSIS relies heavily on climate debt (residual = +2.2) but also on corrective justice framings, while balancing FB and N-FB reasoning. The coalition frequently highlights historical responsibility, unmet commitments, debt burdens, and structural inequalities within existing climate finance mechanisms. However, unlike the LMDC, the AOSIS less frequently engages in direct blame attribution. Instead, the coalition places stronger emphasis on vulnerability, debt sustainability, and the disproportionate burdens faced by SIDS, corresponding with Lefstad and Paavola's (2024) findings. Given the severe fiscal and institutional constraints many SIDS face in accessing climate finance (De Marez et al., 2022), the AOSIS's focus on concessional finance and debt burdens closely reflects material concerns regarding climate vulnerability and financial sustainability.

The coalition's balanced use of FB and N-FB principles may also reflect strategic negotiation considerations. Vulnerable states often avoid highly confrontational language out of concern that explicit blame attribution could undermine cooperation within negotiations (Audet, 2013). The AOSIS therefore, combines reparative justice claims with cooperative and vulnerability-centred framings, enabling it to emphasise climate injustice while maintaining diplomatic legitimacy. In this regard, lessons learned framings function as indirect corrective justice claims aimed at preventing the repetition of past injustices.

The expectations concerning the LMDC are likewise supported. The coalition relies strongly on FB principles (residual = +3.2) emphasizing historical responsibility, corrective justice, and climate debt framings, while largely avoiding distributive justice framings and N-FB principles (residual = -2.9). The LMDC submissions frequently invoke the PPP, BPP, UPPP, lessons learned, and debt burden framings, highlighting historical emissions, unmet commitments, and the obligation of developed countries to address past injustices. These arguments not only reinforce reparative justice claims but also serve a strategic purpose. By grounding responsibility in historical emissions, the LMDC resist attempts to extend formal climate finance obligations to emerging economies despite their growing current emissions (Crippa et al., 2025). This supports earlier research showing that emerging economies use historical responsibility framings to defend the developed-developing country distinction embedded in

CBDR-RC (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024; Okereke & Coventry, 2016). The coalition's strong opposition to expanding the contributor base further reflects concerns that weakening this distinction could undermine the protected status of developing countries within the UNFCCC regime (Blaxekjær & Nielsen, 2016).

The comparison between coalitions also reveals a broader political divide over FB and N-FB principles. The EU and LMDC positions reflect an ongoing struggle over who should ultimately bear responsibility for climate finance provision, with AOSIS occupying a more intermediate position. Earlier literature often describes a divide primarily between developed and developing countries. However, the findings suggest a deeper disagreement over how responsibility itself should be defined: through historical emissions and past harms or through present capabilities and collective future action.

The analysis further demonstrates that paying principles remain highly contested and open to interpretation. Although coalitions often invoke the same principles, their meanings differ substantially. For example, the LMDC frame the PPP primarily in relation to historical emissions, whereas the EU applies it in a forward-looking manner focused on current and future emitters. This supports Okereke's (2010) argument that climate justice principles are inherently contested within international negotiations. Consequently, climate justice theories and paying principles therefore function less as fixed categories than as flexible argumentative tools used to legitimise competing negotiating positions.

Overall, the findings show that NCQG negotiations are shaped by fundamentally competing interpretations of justice, responsibility, and burden-sharing. While developed countries increasingly promote capability- and cooperation-based framings that diffuse responsibility more broadly, developing and emerging coalitions continue to emphasise historical responsibility, reparative justice, and climate debt to defend differentiation and secure financial commitments from developed countries.

## **7.2. FINAL DECISION DOCUMENT**

Regarding the second sub-question on which principles ultimately prevail in the final decision document, the analysis of Decision 1/CMA.6 demonstrates that the final NCQG agreement primarily reflects climate debt and distributive framings, while explicit corrective justice language remains largely absent.

Most notably, the decision incorporates N-FB framings related to debt burdens, regarding concessional finance, and the global mobilisation of capital. Its emphasis on reducing financial barriers, addressing unsustainable debt levels, and increasing grant-based and concessional finance closely reflects demands raised by the AOSIS and LMDC. This suggests that developing country coalitions were at least partly successful in shifting the negotiations beyond purely quantitative targets towards concerns about the quality and structural conditions of climate finance (Pauw, 2025).

At the same time, the language of the agreement remains largely technocratic and cooperative, avoiding explicit references to blame, compensation, reparations, or legal liability. Although the AOSIS and LMDC rely heavily on FB framings during negotiations, these claims are only indirectly incorporated through references to debt burdens and the special needs of developing countries, demonstrating that developed countries have consistently resisted the institutionalisation of compensation-based or liability-oriented climate justice claims within the UNFCCC framework (Adelman, 2016; Calliari, 2018; Okereke & Coventry, 2016). The outcome therefore, reflects the broader tendency within climate negotiations to acknowledge justice concerns while translating them into less confrontational, recommendatory formulations to help all parties agree to the final document when consensus among highly divided parties is needed (Genovese, 2013). Therefore explicit FB corrective justice language also remains absent.

The decision also emphasises the mobilisation of finance from a broad range of public and private actors and highlights the existence of sufficient global capital to address climate challenges. While developed countries are reaffirmed as continuing to take the lead, references to voluntary South-South cooperation and wider financial mobilisation indicate a gradual shift towards a broader understanding of responsibility within the climate finance regime. This partially reflects the EU's position advocating a broader contributor base and acknowledges evolving economic realities of emerging countries in climate finance provision.

Overall, the final agreement represents a political compromise between competing justice logics: preserving the historical obligations of developed countries while cautiously recognising the growing economic capabilities and financial role of emerging economies. Rather than resolving underlying conflicts over responsibility and fairness, the NCQG institutionalises an ambiguous middle ground capable of accommodating competing climate justice interpretations simultaneously.

### **7.3. IMPLICATIONS**

The findings of this thesis reveal that climate finance negotiations under the UNFCCC remain deeply shaped by competing understandings of climate justice. The divide between distributive, corrective, and climate debt framings demonstrates that disagreements over climate finance are not merely technical disputes about funding levels, but broader normative conflicts over responsibility, obligation, and fairness. These conflicting interpretations continue to complicate consensus-building and are likely to remain central in future negotiations on the implementation of the NCQG (Audet, 2013).

One major implication concerns the ongoing contestation over the contributor base. While the EU increasingly promotes a broader understanding of responsibility that includes economically capable developing countries and private actors (EU May 2023), the AOSIS and LMDC continue to defend historical responsibility and reject a widened contributor base (AOSIS Jun 2024; LMDC Nov 2024). This suggests that future negotiations will likely revolve around whether climate finance should remain primarily a legal obligation of developed countries or evolve into a broader burden-sharing framework that reflects changing economic realities (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024; Yeo & Evans, 2015). The findings therefore, indicate that attempts to expand the contributor base without addressing historical responsibility claims risk intensifying tensions between developed and developing countries.

The analysis also highlights the growing importance of the quality of climate finance. While earlier research focused mainly on the quantum or climate finance in general (Islam, 2022; Khan et al., 2019), the quality of climate finance has remained underexplored. Across coalitions, concerns about debt burdens, concessionality, and access barriers emerged as highly salient. The AOSIS and LMDC in particular criticise financial structures that exacerbate indebtedness in vulnerable states (AOSIS Jun 2024; EU Aug 2023; LMDC Sep 2023). These findings support recent scholarship arguing that climate finance debates are increasingly shifting from questions of quantity towards issues of accessibility, financial instruments, and debt sustainability (Pauw, 2025). From a policy perspective, this suggests growing pressure for future climate finance mechanisms to prioritise grants, concessional finance, and debt-relief mechanisms over loan-based instruments.

### **7.4. LIMITATIONS**

Although the analysis yields strong evidence that the three coalitions rely on different climate justice theories and paying principles, especially regarding FB and N-FB reasoning, several limitations must be acknowledged.

First, this thesis prioritizes a comprehensive analysis of official UNFCCC submission documents to capture the most direct and comparable written expressions of coalition positions. However, submissions are voluntary and issue-selective, resulting in an uneven number of documents and potential topic bias (Genovese, 2013). Moreover, while submissions present strategically constructed public positions (Calliari, 2018), they cannot capture informal bargaining, personal perspectives, or compromise-seeking arguments that occur behind closed doors (Högl, 2018). Future research should therefore examine the informal dynamics of the NCQG negotiations to assess how these diverge from public submissions. The exclusion of one French submission – while necessary for maintaining a consistent analytical lens – may also have created bias, underrepresenting some positions (Lefstad & Paavola, 2024).

Second, the study acknowledges that there is often a disconnect between rhetoric and action in international agreements (Kowalzig et al., 2025; OECD, 2024). The analysis cannot determine whether coalition positions reflect genuine normative commitments or strategic rhetoric aimed at advancing political interests (Davidson, 2021).

Third, the thesis treats each coalition as a unified actor despite internal diversity among member states. Although appropriate for examining collective outputs, this approach may obscure internal tensions and disagreements within coalitions. As such, the submissions likely reflect negotiated internal compromises rather than fully unified normative perspectives (Klöck et al., 2021, 2025).

Fourth, while the selected coalitions represent a diverse set of central actors in climate finance negotiations, the study does not capture the full diversity of the UNFCCC landscape. Excluding groups such as the BASIC group, the African Group, the Umbrella Group, civil society organisations, or private actors may overlook alternative climate justice framings.

Fifth, a quantification of coding results might risk misinterpreting the hierarchy of different principles in the arguments of the coalitions. Small differences in the frequency of use of a principle should thus not be seen as key evidence, the focus should be on larger differences.



Sixth, the analysis focuses on mapping dominant paying principles in coalition submissions but does not establish causal influence on the final NCQG outcome. Future research could investigate how bargaining power and shifting coalition priorities shape the final decision text.

Finally, qualitative frame analysis enables the detection of different climate theories and paying principle arguments; however, the coding necessarily entails interpretive assessment. Because countries often use diplomatic and rather vague language, the distinction between frames, particularly FB and N-FB reasoning, can rely on contextual reading rather than purely objective indicators. Although submissions were coded multiple times to ensure coherence, subjective interpretation remained, since no inter-coder reliability test was conducted. In addition, some passages required multiple coding because climate justice frames frequently overlap.

Overall, these limitations highlight both the strengths and constraints of the study while already indicating important directions for future research.

## **7.5. FURTHER RESEARCH**

An important future research topic concerns the role of private actors in climate finance provisions. As expectations for private-sector contributions continue to grow, further research should examine whether and how private finance can support climate justice objectives. Existing scholarship suggests that private finance has created additional challenges for equitable climate finance provision. Although frequently presented as essential for closing the global climate finance gap, private finance typically follows market-based rather than justice-based logics (Bracking & Leffel, 2021). Consequently, they tend to prioritise mitigation over adaptation finance, rely predominantly on loans and equity instead of grants, and often avoid highly vulnerable countries due to low profitability and difficult investment conditions (Kalinowski, 2024). This is particularly problematic for vulnerable states such as AOSIS members, where adaptation finance is crucial to address immediate climate impacts (Okereke, 2010). Future research should therefore explore how private finance mechanisms could be redesigned to better align with distributive and vulnerability-based climate justice principles.

Further research is also needed on how climate finance can be delivered without exacerbating debt burdens, particularly in highly vulnerable developing countries. Colenbrander et al. (2018), for example, provide valuable insights into the more equitable allocation of adaptation finance at the local level. At the international level, however, climate finance architecture is frequently criticised for its fragmentation, complex access procedures, and conditionalities, all of which increase administrative burdens and costs for developing countries (Watson et al., 2025). As

this thesis has demonstrated, concerns over debt-creating financial structures have become central to contemporary climate finance negotiations. Future studies should therefore focus more strongly on policy solutions that simplify access to climate finance and expand the availability of concessional and grant-based funding.

Finally, future research should examine the informal negotiations processes shaping NCQG outcomes beyond official submissions. Climate negotiations are influenced not only by formal bargaining but also unfold across smaller meetings, personal exchanges, and trust-building interactions that can significantly affect coalition formation and compromise. Research on the Paris Agreement negotiations demonstrates the importance of informal communication and personal relationships for cooperation (Högl, 2018). Similar studies on the NCQG could therefore analyse how informal bargaining modifies, narrows, or reinterprets positions that appear in written submissions. Such research would complement this thesis by shifting attention from publicly articulated positions to the relational dynamics through which negotiated outcomes emerge.

## **8. CONCLUSION**

The study demonstrates a clear divide in the use of paying principles and underlying climate justice theories among coalitions during NCQG negotiations. The strongest divergence emerges in the application of FB and N-FB principles. The EU relies predominantly on N-FB principles, while largely avoiding FB framings. In contrast, the LMDC strongly emphasise FB principles, and make only limited use of N-FB reasoning. The AOSIS adopts a more balanced and diplomatic approach, combining both forms while attributing blame to developed countries less directly than the LMDC. These findings suggest that the EU and LMDC strategically employ different forms of responsibility attribution to shape expectations regarding who should contribute to climate finance. Notably, however, this divide is not reflected in the final NCQG decision text, which relies exclusively on N-FB framings.

A similar divergence appears in the use of climate justice theories. The EU primarily employs distributive climate justice framings, focusing on present capabilities, collective action, and the broader mobilisation of climate finance. At the same time, it makes only limited references to corrective and climate debt justice, refraining from claims of historical responsibility. In contrast, the AOSIS relies most strongly on climate debt justice, followed by corrective justice, whereas distributive justice framings remain comparatively limited. A similar pattern is visible with the LMDC, where corrective justice dominates, followed by climate debt justice. These findings indicate that historical responsibilities and past injustices continue to shape the climate

finance positions of the AOSIS and LMDC more strongly than considerations of present capability.

The analysis of the final decision text provides an additional insight. The document mainly reflects climate debt justice through N-FB debt burden framings, alongside distributive climate justice framings through the paying principle of global effort. This supports broader findings that the quality and accessibility of climate finance have become an increasingly important issue within climate finance negotiations.

Overall, the findings illustrate that climate finance remains a highly contested field within the UNFCCC regime, in which coalitions strategically employ different climate justice framings to legitimise their positions and shape responsibility allocation. These competing interpretations of justice risk undermining the effectiveness and ambition of future climate finance agreements. As Simon Stiell, UN Climate Change Executive Secretary, stated, the NCQG represents “an insurance policy for humanity” (UNFCCC, 2024), underscoring the continuing importance of climate finance in addressing the global climate crisis.

## REFERENCES

- Adelman, S. (2016). Climate justice, loss and damage and compensation for small island developing states. *Journal of Human Rights and the Environment*, 7(1), 32–53.  
<https://doi.org/10.4337/jhre.2016.01.02>
- Adger, W. N. (2006). Vulnerability. *Global Environmental Change*, 16(3), 268–281.  
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gloenvcha.2006.02.006>
- Adil, L., Eckstein, D., Künzel, V., & Schäfer, L. (2025). *Climate Risk Index 2026. Who suffers most from extreme weather events?* (Climate Risk Index). Germanwatch.  
<https://www.germanwatch.org/en/cri>
- Agresti, A. (1996). *An introduction to categorical data analysis*.
- Audet, R. (2013). Climate justice and bargaining coalitions: A discourse analysis. *International Environmental Agreements: Politics, Law and Economics*, 13(3), 369–386. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10784-012-9195-9>
- Bartlett, C. Y. (2026). Loss and damage funding arrangements: Role of the Republic of Vanuatu in shaping global policy and practice. *Frontiers in Human Dynamics*, 7, 1658909. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fhumd.2025.1658909>
- Bastos, M. F. R., & Duleba, W. (2025). The new climate fund for loss and damage of the Paris Agreement: Discussions on financing and climate justice. *Revista Brasileira de Política Internacional*, 68(1), e003. <https://doi.org/10.1590/0034-7329202500103>
- Béland, D. (2009). Ideas, institutions, and policy change. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 16(5), 701–718. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501760902983382>
- Betsill, M., Dubash, N. K., Paterson, M., Van Asselt, H., Vihma, A., & Winkler, H. (2015). Building Productive Links between the UNFCCC and the Broader Global Climate Governance Landscape. *Global Environmental Politics*, 15(2), 1–10.  
[https://doi.org/10.1162/GLEP\\_a\\_00294](https://doi.org/10.1162/GLEP_a_00294)

- Biermann, F., & Kalfagianni, A. (2020). Planetary justice: A research framework. *Earth System Governance*, 6, 100049. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.esg.2020.100049>
- Blaxekjær, L. Ø., & Nielsen, T. D. (mit Sælen, H., Lahn, B., & Green-Weiskel, L.). (2016). *The Narrative Position of the Like Minded Developing Countries in Global Climate Negotiations: A Policy-Oriented Narrative Approach to IR*. <https://refubium.fu-berlin.de/bitstream/handle/fub188/17829/BlaxekjxrxdNielsenxNewxNarrativexPositionsx-ThexLikexMindedxDevelopingxCountriesx-xESGxBerlinx201.pdf?sequence=1>
- Bohle, H. G., Downing, T. E., & Watts, M. J. (1994). Climate change and social vulnerability. *Global Environmental Change*, 4(1), 37–48. [https://doi.org/10.1016/0959-3780\(94\)90020-5](https://doi.org/10.1016/0959-3780(94)90020-5)
- Bolsen, T., & Shapiro, M. A. (2018). The US News Media, Polarization on Climate Change, and Pathways to Effective Communication. *Environmental Communication*, 12(2), 149–163. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17524032.2017.1397039>
- Bracking, S., & Leffel, B. (2021). Climate finance governance: Fit for purpose? *WIREs Climate Change*, 12(4), e709. <https://doi.org/10.1002/wcc.709>
- Brazilian Party. (1997). Proposed elements of a protocol to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, presented by Brazil in response to the Berlin mandate. (*Item 3 of the provisional agenda of the seventh session of the ad hoc group on the Berlin mandate, FCCC/AGBM/1997/ MISC.1/Add.3.*). Paper no. 1, Brazil, presented at the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), May 30. <https://unfccc.int/resource/docs/1997/agbm/03b.pdf>
- Brownbridge, M., & Canagarajah, S. (2024). *Climate Change Vulnerability, Adaptation and Public Debt Sustainability in Small Island Developing States* (Policy Research Working Paper 10787). Washington, DC: World Bank. <https://doi.org/10.1596/1813-9450-10787>

- Brunnée, J., & Streck, C. (2013). The UNFCCC as a negotiation forum: Towards common but more differentiated responsibilities. *Climate Policy*, 13(5), 589–607.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2013.822661>
- Calliari, E. (2018). Loss and damage: A critical discourse analysis of Parties' positions in climate change negotiations. *Journal of Risk Research*, 21(6), 725–747.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/13669877.2016.1240706>
- Caney, S. (2005). Cosmopolitan Justice, Responsibility, and Global Climate Change. *Leiden Journal of International Law*, 18(4), 747–775.  
<https://doi.org/10.1017/S0922156505002992>
- Caney, S. (2009). Justice and the distribution of greenhouse gas emissions<sup>1</sup>. *Journal of Global Ethics*, 5(2), 125–146. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17449620903110300>
- Caney, S. (2010). In *Human Rights and Climate Change*. Cambridge University Press, 69–90.
- Caney, S. (2018). Distributive Justice and Climate Change. *Oxford Handbook of Distributive Justice*. <https://philarchive.org/archive/CANDJA>
- Chaplain, J. (2025). The Necessity of Just Communication for Advancing Climate Justice: Reflections on Contributions for Communication Scholars at COP. *Western Journal of Communication*, 89(5), 847–864. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10570314.2025.2553278>
- Cherry-Virdee, T. (2025). Hollow commitments 2025: An analysis of developed countries' climate finance plans and targets. *CARE Denmark*. [https://careclimatechange.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/06/CARE\\_Report-Hollow-Commitments-2025-REV2.pdf](https://careclimatechange.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/06/CARE_Report-Hollow-Commitments-2025-REV2.pdf)
- Ciplet, D. (2017). Subverting the status quo? Climate debt, vulnerability and counter-hegemonic frame integration in United Nations climate politics – a framework for analysis. *Review of International Political Economy*, 24(6), 1052–1075.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/09692290.2017.1392336>
- Ciplet, D., Falzon, D., Uri, I., Robinson, S., Weikmans, R., & Roberts, J. T. (2022). The unequal geographies of climate finance: Climate injustice and dependency in the

- world system. *Political Geography*, 99, 102769.  
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.polgeo.2022.102769>
- Ciplet, D., Fields, S., Madden, K., Khan, M., & Roberts, T. J. (2012). *The eight unmet promises of fast-start climate finance*. <https://www.iied.org/17141iied>
- Ciplet, D., Roberts, J. T., & Khan, M. (2013). The Politics of International Climate Adaptation Funding: Justice and Divisions in the Greenhouse. *Global Environmental Politics*, 13(1), 49–68. [https://doi.org/10.1162/GLEP\\_a\\_00153](https://doi.org/10.1162/GLEP_a_00153)
- Ciplet, D., Roberts, J. T., & Khan, M. R. (2015). *Power in a warming world: The new global politics of climate change and the remaking of environmental inequality*. MIT press.
- Cohen, J. (1977). *Statistical Power Analysis for the Behavioral Sciences* (Revised Edition). Academic Press.
- Colenbrander, S., Cao, Y., Pettinotti, L., Robertson, M., Hedger, M., & Gonzalez, L. (2023). *The New Collective Quantified Goal and its sources of funding* (Working Paper). ODI. [https://media.odi.org/documents/ODI\\_The\\_new\\_collective\\_quantified\\_goal\\_and\\_sources\\_of\\_funding.pdf](https://media.odi.org/documents/ODI_The_new_collective_quantified_goal_and_sources_of_funding.pdf)
- Colenbrander, S., Dodman, D., & Mitlin, D. (2018). Using climate finance to advance climate justice: The politics and practice of channelling resources to the local level. *Climate Policy*, 18(7), 902–915. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2017.1388212>
- Crippa, M., Guizzardi, D., Pagani, F., Banja, M., & Muntean, M. (2025). *GHG emissions of all world countries: 2025 Report*. Publications Office of the European Union. <https://doi.org/10.2760/9816914>
- Cutter, S. L., Emrich, C. T., Webb, J. J., & Morath, D. (2009). *Social Vulnerability to Climate Variability Hazards: A Review of the Literature. Final Report to Oxfam America*. Hazards and Vulnerability Research Institute, University of South Carolina. <https://web.archive.org/web/20241221224957/https://citeseerx.ist.psu.edu/document?repid=rep1&type=pdf&doi=e0708976f51536074aba4cf7fd5375d9c8f58c2b>

- Dafermos, Y. (2025). Climate finance and global justice. *Climate Policy*, 1–17.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2025.2482104>
- Davidson, M. D. (2021). How Fairness Principles in the Climate Debate Relate to Theories of Distributive Justice. *Sustainability*, 13(13), 7302. <https://doi.org/10.3390/su13137302>
- De Marez, L., Bee, S., Bartle, B., Chintulga, O., & Nguyen, C. (2022). *Accessing Climate Finance: Challenges and Opportunities for Small Island Developing States*. UN-OHRLLS.  
[https://www.un.org/ohrlls/sites/www.un.org.ohrlls/files/accessing\\_climate\\_finance\\_challenges\\_sids\\_report.pdf](https://www.un.org/ohrlls/sites/www.un.org.ohrlls/files/accessing_climate_finance_challenges_sids_report.pdf)
- Eckersley, R. (2012). Moving Forward in the Climate Negotiations: Multilateralism or Minilateralism? *Global Environmental Politics*, 12(2), 24–42.  
[https://doi.org/10.1162/GLEP\\_a\\_00107](https://doi.org/10.1162/GLEP_a_00107)
- Entman, R. M. (1993). Framing: Towards clarification of a fractured paradigm. *McQuail's reader in mass communication theory*, 390–397.
- Falduto, C., Noels, J., & Jachnik, R. (mit OECD). (2024). *The New Collective Quantified Goal on climate finance: Options for reflecting the role of different sources, actors, and qualitative considerations* (2 Nr. 2024).
- Ferreira, P. G. (2018). *Climate Finance Obligations: Continuities*. In *Climate Finance and Transparency in the Paris Agreement: Key Current and Emerging Legal Issues* (S. 4–6). Centre for International Governance Innovation.  
<https://www.jstor.org/stable/resrep24962.9>
- Flåm, K. H., & Skjærseth, J. B. (2009). Does adequate financing exist for adaptation in developing countries? *Climate Policy*, 9(1), 109–114.  
<https://doi.org/10.3763/cpol.2008.0568>



- Forman, J., & Damschroder, L. (2007). Qualitative Content Analysis. In *Advances in Bioethics* (Bd. 11, S. 39–62). Elsevier. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S1479-3709\(07\)11003-7](https://doi.org/10.1016/S1479-3709(07)11003-7)
- Fraser, N. (1998). *Social Justice in the Age of Identity Politics: Redistribution, Recognition, Participation*. [https:// www.ssoar.info/ssoar/bitstream/handle/document/12624/ssoar-1998-fraser-social\\_justice\\_in\\_the\\_age.pdf?sequence=1](https://www.ssoar.info/ssoar/bitstream/handle/document/12624/ssoar-1998-fraser-social_justice_in_the_age.pdf?sequence=1)
- Gabbatiss, J. (2024). COP29: What is the ‘new collective quantified goal’ on climate finance? *Carbon Brief: Clear on Climate*. <https://www.carbonbrief.org/cop29-what-is-the-new-collective-quantified-goal-on-climate-finance/>
- Gach, E. (2019). Normative Shifts in the Global Conception of Climate Change: The Growth of Climate Justice. *Social Sciences*, 8(1), 24. <https://doi.org/10.3390/socsci8010024>
- Gardiner, S. M. (2004). Ethics and Global Climate Change. *Ethics*, 114(3), 555–600. <https://doi.org/10.1086/382247>
- Gaunt, R. E., Pickett, A. M., & Reinert, G. (2017). Chi-square approximation by Stein’s method with application to Pearson’s statistic. *The Annals of Applied Probability*, 27(2). <https://doi.org/10.1214/16-AAP1213>
- Genovese, F. (2013). *States’ Interests at the Climate Change Negotiations: New Measures of Bargaining Positions*.
- Goffman, E. (1974). *Frame Analysis: An Essay on the Organization of Experience*. Northeastern University Press.
- Goodin, R. E. (1989). Theories of Compensatio. *Oxford Journal of Legal Studies*, 9(1), 56–75.
- Grosse, C., & Mark, B. (2020). A colonized COP: Indigenous exclusion and youth climate justice activism at the United Nations climate change negotiations. *Journal of Human Rights and the Environment*, 11(3), 146–170. <https://doi.org/10.4337/jhre.2020.03.07>

- Halkyer, R. O. (2021). COP 21 – Complaints and Negotiation: The Role of the Like-Minded Developing Countries Group (LMDC) and the Paris Agreement. In H. Jepsen, M. Lundgren, K. Monheim, & H. Walker (Hrsg.), *Negotiating the Paris Agreement* (1. Aufl., S. 160–181). Cambridge University Press.  
<https://doi.org/10.1017/9781108886246.009>
- Harlan, S. L., Pellow, D. N., Roberts, J. T., Bell, S. E., Holt, W. G., & Nagel, J. (2015). Climate Justice and Inequality. In R. E. Dunlap & R. J. Brulle (Hrsg.), *Climate Change and Society* (S. 127–163). Oxford University Press.  
<https://doi.org/10.1093/acprof:oso/9780199356102.003.0005>
- Hijrah, N., & Valiantien, N. M. (2026). Critical discourse analysis of climate justice at the COP27. *Ilmu Budaya: Jurnal Bahasa, Sastra, Seni, dan Budaya*, 10(1), 89–98.
- Högl, M. (2018). Enabling factors for cooperation in the climate negotiations: A comparative analysis of Copenhagen 2009 and Paris 2015. In *Discussion Paper 14/2018* (Version 1.0). German Institute of Development and Sustainability.  
<https://doi.org/10.23661/DP14.2018>
- IPCC. (1990). *Climate Change. The IPCC Impacts Assessment. Report prepared for IPCC by Working Group II* (W. J. McG. Tegart, G. W. Sheldon, & D. C. Griffiths, Hrsg.; S. 296 pages).  
[https://www.ipcc.ch/site/assets/uploads/2018/02/ipcc\\_far\\_wg\\_II\\_full\\_report.pdf](https://www.ipcc.ch/site/assets/uploads/2018/02/ipcc_far_wg_II_full_report.pdf)
- IPCC. (2014). *Annex II: Glossary [Mach, K.J., S. Planton and C. von Stechow (eds.)]. In: Climate Change 2014: Synthesis Report. Contribution of Working Groups I, II and III to the Fifth Assessment Report of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change [Core Writing Team, R.K. Pachauri and L.A. Meyer (eds.)]* (S. 1758–1776). Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC).  
[https://www.ipcc.ch/site/assets/uploads/2018/02/WGIIAR5-AnnexII\\_FINAL.pdf](https://www.ipcc.ch/site/assets/uploads/2018/02/WGIIAR5-AnnexII_FINAL.pdf)

- IPCC. (2023a). *Climate Change 2023: Synthesis Report* (Contribution of Working Groups I, II and III to the Sixth Assessment Report of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change [Core Writing Team, H. Lee and J. Romero (eds.)]; S. 184 pp). Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC).  
<https://doi.org/10.59327/IPCC/AR6-9789291691647>
- IPCC (Hrsg.). (2023b). Investment and Finance. In *Climate Change 2022—Mitigation of Climate Change* (1. Aufl., S. 1547–1640). Cambridge University Press.  
<https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009157926.017> (Ursprünglich erschienen Intergovernmental Panel On Climate Change)
- Isah, A., Egli, F., Schmidt, T. S., & Stünzi, A. (2025). Quantifying climate finance needs in the nationally determined contributions of developing countries. *Climate Policy*, 25(9), 1442–1459. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2025.2460607>
- Islam, Md. M. (2022). Distributive justice in global climate finance – Recipients’ climate vulnerability and the allocation of climate funds. *Global Environmental Change*, 73, 102475. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gloenvcha.2022.102475>
- Jafino, B. A., Kwakkkel, J. H., & Taebi, B. (2021). Enabling assessment of distributive justice through models for climate change planning: A review of recent advances and a research agenda. *WIREs Climate Change*, 12(4), e721.  
<https://doi.org/10.1002/wcc.721>
- Jagers, S. C., & Duus-Otterström, G. (2008). Dual climate change responsibility: On moral divergences between mitigation and adaptation. *Environmental Politics*, 17(4), 576–591. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09644010802193443>
- Kalinowski, T. (2024). The Green Climate Fund and private sector climate finance in the Global South. *Climate Policy*, 24(3), 281–296.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2023.2276857>

- Kashwan, P. (2021). Climate Justice in the Global North. *Case Studies in the Environment*, 5(1), 1125003. <https://doi.org/10.1525/cse.2021.1125003>
- Khan, M. I., Asfand, F., Asif, M., Hadi, N. U., Farooq, M., Kurniawan, T. A., & Al-Ghamdi, S. G. (2026). COP29 at the climate crossroads: Achievements, gaps, and implications for a warming world. *Frontiers in Climate*, 7, 1685999. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fclim.2025.1685999>
- Khan, M., Robinson, S., Ciplet, D., & Roberts, J. T. (2019). Twenty-five years of adaptation finance through a climate justice lens. *Climatic Change*, 161(2), 251–269. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10584-019-02563-x>
- Klöck, C., Baatz, C., & Wendler, N. (2025). Procedural justice and (in)equitable participation in climate negotiations. *UCL Open Environment*, 7(1). <https://doi.org/10.14324/111.444/ucloe.3116>
- Klöck, C., Castro, P., & Weiler, F. (2021). *Coalitions in the Climate Change Negotiations (LIEPP Policy Brief, n°55)*. Sciences Po - LIEPP. <https://doi.org/10.25647/LIEPP.PB.55>
- Kowalzig, J., Nordbo, J., Sørensen, R. B., Cherry-Virdee, T., Dejgaard, H. P., & Dabi, N. (2025). *Climate Finance Shadow Report 2025: Analysing progress on climate finance under the Paris Agreement*. Oxfam International. <https://doi.org/10.21201/2025.000088>
- Kuyper, J., Schroeder, H., & Linnér, B.-O. (2018). The Evolution of the UNFCCC. *Annual Review of Environment and Resources*, 43(1), 343–368. <https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-environ-102017-030119>
- Lefstad, L., & Paavola, J. (2024). The evolution of climate justice claims in global climate change negotiations under the UNFCCC. *Critical Policy Studies*, 18(3), 363–388. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19460171.2023.2235405>

- Levy, B. S., & Patz, J. A. (2015). Climate Change, Human Rights, and Social Justice. *Annals of Global Health*, 81(3), 310. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.aogh.2015.08.008>
- Mahendru, M., Parihar, J. S., Jain, A., & Sharma, G. D. (2025). The Equity Imperative: Revisiting COP Frameworks Through a Justice Lens. *Journal of Environmental Assessment Policy and Management*, 27(04), 2550012. <https://doi.org/10.1142/S1464333225500127>
- Massenberg, J. R. (2021). Global Climate Change—Who Ought to Pay the Bill? *Sustainability*, 13(23), 13393. <https://doi.org/10.3390/su132313393>
- McHugh, M. L. (2013). The Chi-square test of independence. *Biochemia Medica*, 143–149. <https://doi.org/10.11613/BM.2013.018>
- McKinnon, C. (2009). Climate Change and Corrective Justice. *Jahrbuch fur Recht und Ethik*, 17, 259–276.
- Metreau, E., Young, K. E., & Eapen, S. G. (2025). Understanding country income: World Bank Group income classifications for FY26 (July 1, 2025–June, 2026). *World Bank Blogs*. <https://blogs.worldbank.org/en/opendata/understanding-country-income--world-bank-group-income-classifica>
- Moss, J. (Hrsg.). (2009). *Climate change and social justice*. Melbourne Univ. Publishing.
- Munira, S., Bashar, R., Easher, T. H., & Khan, M. R. (2021). Climate Finance in the UNFCCC Negotiations: Bridging Gaps with Lessons Learnt. In Md. Jakariya & Md. N. Islam (Hrsg.), *Climate Change in Bangladesh* (S. 1–24). Springer International Publishing. [https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-75825-7\\_1](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-75825-7_1)
- Nelson, R., Kokic, P., Crimp, S., Meinke, H., & Howden, S. M. (2010). The vulnerability of Australian rural communities to climate variability and change: Part I—Conceptualising and measuring vulnerability. *Environmental Science & Policy*, 13(1), 8–17. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.envsci.2009.09.006>

- Neumayer, E. (2000). In defence of historical accountability for greenhouse gas emissions. *Ecological Economics*, 33(2), 185–192. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0921-8009\(00\)00135-X](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0921-8009(00)00135-X)
- Nhamo, G., & Nhamo, S. (2016). Paris (COP21) Agreement: Loss and damage, adaptation and climate finance issues. *International Journal of African Renaissance Studies - Multi-, Inter- and Transdisciplinarity*, 11(2), 118–138. <https://doi.org/10.1080/18186874.2016.1212479>
- OECD. (1995). *ENVIRONMENTAL PRINCIPLES AND CONCEPTS* (General Distribution OCDE/GD(95)124).
- OECD. (2024). *Climate Finance Provided and Mobilised by Developed Countries in 2013-2022*. OECD Publishing. <https://doi.org/10.1787/19150727-en>
- OHCH. (2015). *Understanding Human Rights and Climate Change*. Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights. <https://www.ohchr.org/Documents/Issues/ClimateChange/COP21.pdf>
- Okereke, C. (2010). Climate justice and the international regime. *WIREs Climate Change*, 1(3), 462–474. <https://doi.org/10.1002/wcc.52>
- Okereke, C., & Coventry, P. (2016). Climate justice and the international regime: Before, during, and after Paris. *WIREs Climate Change*, 7(6), 834–851. <https://doi.org/10.1002/wcc.419>
- Paavola, J., & Adger, W. N. (2006). Fair adaptation to climate change. *Ecological Economics*, 56(4), 594–609. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecolecon.2005.03.015>
- Pacifici, M., Foden, W. B., Visconti, P., Watson, J. E. M., Butchart, S. H. M., Kovacs, K. M., Scheffers, B. R., Hole, D. G., Martin, T. G., Akçakaya, H. R., Corlett, R. T., Huntley, B., Bickford, D., Carr, J. A., Hoffmann, A. A., Midgley, G. F., Pearce-Kelly, P., Pearson, R. G., Williams, S. E., ... Rondinini, C. (2015). Assessing species

- vulnerability to climate change. *Nature Climate Change*, 5(3), 215–224.  
<https://doi.org/10.1038/nclimate2448>
- Page, E. A. (2012). Give it up for climate change: A defence of the beneficiary pays principle. *International Theory*, 4(2), 300–330. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S175297191200005X>
- Parikh, K. S. (1993). The Polluter-Pays and User-Pays Principles for developing countries; merits, drawbacks and feasibility. In E. Dommen (Hrsg.), *Fair Principles for Sustainable Development* (S. 81–92). Edward Elgar Publishing.  
<https://doi.org/10.4337/9781035303083.00011>
- Pauw, W. P. (2025). The three missed opportunities of the UNFCCC’s New Collective Quantified Goal on climate finance. *Earth System Governance*, 24, 100255.  
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.esg.2025.100255>
- Pettinotti, L., Kamninga, T. M., & ColenbranderID, S. (2024). *A fair share of climate finance? : The collective aspects of the New Collective Quantified Goal*. ODI Working Paper. <https://odi.org/en/publications/a-fair-share-of-climate-finance-the-collective-aspects-of-the-ncqg>
- Pickering, J., Betzold, C., & Skovgaard, J. (2017). Special issue: Managing fragmentation and complexity in the emerging system of international climate finance. *International Environmental Agreements: Politics, Law and Economics*, 17(1), 1–16.  
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s10784-016-9349-2>
- Rawls, J. (1971). A theory of justice. *Harvard University Press*.
- Robinson, M., & Shine, T. (2018). Achieving a climate justice pathway to 1.5 °C. *Nature Climate Change*, 8(7), 564–569. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41558-018-0189-7>
- Saerbeck, B., Well, M., Jörgens, H., Goritz, A., & Kolleck, N. (2020). Brokering Climate Action: The UNFCCC Secretariat Between Parties and Nonparty Stakeholders. *Global Environmental Politics*, 20(2), 105–127. [https://doi.org/10.1162/glep\\_a\\_00556](https://doi.org/10.1162/glep_a_00556)

- Schlosberg, D., & Collins, L. B. (2014). From environmental to climate justice: Climate change and the discourse of environmental justice. *WIREs Climate Change*, 5(3), 359–374. <https://doi.org/10.1002/wcc.275>
- SEKK Development. (n.d.). *Climate. Donor Tracker*. [Datensatz].  
<https://donortracker.org/topics/climate>
- Sengupta, S. (2019). India's engagement in global climate negotiations from Rio to Paris. In D. Navroz (Hrsg.), *India in a warming world: Integrating climate change and development*. Oxford University Press.
- Shue, H. (1993). Subsistence Emissions and Luxury Emissions. *Law & Policy*, 15(1), 39–60.  
<https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1467-9930.1993.tb00093.x>
- Shue, H. (1999). Global Environment and International Inequality. *International Affairs*, 75(3), 531–545. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1468-2346.00092>
- Sirkin, R. M. (2006). *Statistics for the social sciences*. Sage.
- Snow, D., & Byrd, S. (2007). Ideology, Framing Processes, and Islamic Terrorist Movements. *Mobilization: An International Quarterly*, 12(2), 119–136.  
<https://doi.org/10.17813/maiq.12.2.5717148712w21410>
- Sultana, F. (2022). Critical climate justice. *The Geographical Journal*, 188(1), 118–124.  
<https://doi.org/10.1111/geoj.12417>
- Tan, E., & Pettinotti, L. (2024). *Informing the New Collective Quantified Goal quantum: Unpacking cost estimates for developing countries' needs*. ODI Report. ODI.  
<https://media.odi.org/documents/ODI-SM-Quantum-NCQG-WP-Sep24-Proof09.pdf>
- Tan, K. (2023). Climate reparations: Why the polluter pays principle is neither unfair nor unreasonable. *WIREs Climate Change*, 14(4), e827. <https://doi.org/10.1002/wcc.827>
- Thornton, F. (2021). Of Harm, Culprits and Rectification: Obtaining Corrective Justice for Climate Change Displacement. *Transnational Environmental Law*, 10(1), 13–33.  
<https://doi.org/10.1017/S2047102520000230>



- UNCTAD. (2014). *World investment report 2014: Investing in the SDGs: an action plan* (X. J. Zhan, Hrsg.). United Nations Conference on Trade and Development.
- UNFCCC. (2024). „*This New Finance Goal is an Insurance Policy for Humanity*“: Simon Stiell at Close of COP29. <https://unfccc.int/news/this-new-finance-goal-is-an-insurance-policy-for-humanity-simon-stiell-at-close-of-cop29>
- UNFCCC, United Nations (1992).  
[https://unfccc.int/files/essential\\_background/background\\_publications\\_htmlpdf/application/pdf/conveng.pdf](https://unfccc.int/files/essential_background/background_publications_htmlpdf/application/pdf/conveng.pdf)
- UNFCCC. (2015). *Report of the conference of the parties on its twenty-first session, held in Paris from 30 November to 13 December 2015 addendum part two: Action taken by the conference of the parties at its twenty-first session* (Document FCCC/CP/2015/10/Add.1). <http://unfccc.int/resource/docs/2015/cop21/eng/10a01.pdf>
- UNFCCC. (2024a). *About COP 29*. United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC). <https://unfccc.int/cop29/about-cop29>
- UNFCCC. (2024b). *New collective quantified goal on climate finance. Decision-/CMA.6.(Advanced unedited version)*. [https://unfccc.int/sites/default/files/resource/CMA\\_11%28a%29\\_NCQG.pdf](https://unfccc.int/sites/default/files/resource/CMA_11%28a%29_NCQG.pdf)
- UNFCCC. (2025). *Report of the Conference of the Parties serving as the meeting of the Parties to the Paris Agreement on its sixth session, held in Baku from 11 to 24 November 2024* (Document FCCC/PA/CMA/2024/17/Add.1). United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change.  
[https://unfccc.int/sites/default/files/resource/cma2024\\_17a01\\_adv.pdf#page=2](https://unfccc.int/sites/default/files/resource/cma2024_17a01_adv.pdf#page=2)
- UNFCCC. (2026). *UNFCCC Negotiating Group Chairs and Coordinators -May 2026*.  
<https://unfccc.int/documents/648991>
- UNFCCC. (n.d.a). *About the secretariat*. <https://unfccc.int/about-us/about-the-secretariat>

- UNFCCC. (n.d.b). *Introduction to Climate Finance*. <https://unfccc.int/topics/introduction-to-climate-finance>
- UNFCCC. (n.d.c). *New Collective Quantified Goal on Climate Finance*.  
[https://unfccc.int/NCQG#tab\\_home](https://unfccc.int/NCQG#tab_home)
- Vanhala, L., & Hestbaek, C. (2016). Framing Climate Change Loss and Damage in UNFCCC Negotiations. *Global Environmental Politics*, 16(4), 111–129.  
[https://doi.org/10.1162/GLEP\\_a\\_00379](https://doi.org/10.1162/GLEP_a_00379)
- Vogler, J. (2016). *Climate Change in World Politics*.
- Wallimann-Helmer, I. (2015). Justice for climate loss and damage. *Climatic Change*, 133(3), 469–480. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10584-015-1483-2>
- Warlenius, R. (2018). Decolonizing the Atmosphere: The Climate Justice Movement on Climate Debt. *The Journal of Environment & Development*, 27(2), 131–155.  
<https://doi.org/10.1177/1070496517744593>
- Watson, C., Schalatek, L., & Evéquo, A. (2025). The global climate finance architecture. *Climate finance fundamentals*, 2, 1–6.
- Weikmans, R., & Roberts, J. T. (2019). The international climate finance accounting muddle: Is there hope on the horizon? *Climate and Development*, 11(2), 97–111.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/17565529.2017.1410087>
- Yeo, S., & Evans, S. (2015, Dezember 7). Explainer: Why ‘differentiation’ is key to unlocking Paris climate deal. *Carbon Brief*. <https://www.carbonbrief.org/explainer-why-differentiation-is-key-to-unlocking-paris-climate-deal/>
- Young, I. M. (1990). *Justice and the politics of difference*. Princeton University Press.
- Zagama, B., Kowalzig, J., Walsh, L., Hattle, A., Roy, C., & Dejgaard, H. P. (2023). *Climate Finance Shadow Report 2023: Assessing the delivery of the \$100 billion commitment*. Oxfam International. <https://doi.org/10.21201/2023.621500>

## APPENDIX

### Appendix A. Preliminary justice framework

| FL/BL<br>FB/N-F                     | Paying<br>Principles | Arguments                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Target terms                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Theoretical<br>source                          |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Distributive Climate Justice</b> |                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                |
| FL and<br>N-FB                      | APP                  | Regarding each country's capabilities and circumstances, the provision of climate finance should be determined.                                                                                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• "equity"</li> <li>• "fair allocation"</li> <li>• "equitable allocation"</li> <li>• "capabilities"</li> </ul>                                                                                | e.g., Adelman (2016); Paavola and Adger (2006) |
| <b>Corrective Climate Justice</b>   |                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                |
| FL and<br>FB                        | PPP                  | Independent of past emissions, current and future polluters are responsible to provide the financial means against climate change.                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• "compensation"</li> <li>• "rectification"</li> <li>• "restoration"</li> <li>• "fault"</li> <li>• "wrongs"</li> <li>• "current polluters/emitters"</li> </ul>                                | Shue (1999)                                    |
| BL and<br>FB                        | PPP                  | Industrialized countries must, due to their high historical emissions, provide financial compensation to tackle the adverse effects of climate change.                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• "compensation"</li> <li>• "rectification"</li> <li>• "restoration"</li> <li>• "fault"</li> <li>• "wrongs"</li> <li>• "historical emissions/emitters"</li> <li>• "past pollution"</li> </ul> | e.g., Caney (2005); Okereke (2010)             |
| BL and<br>FB                        | BPP                  | The current generation of industrialized countries must provide climate finance, since they have derived benefits from past emissions, positioning them better than descendants of low-emitting countries. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• "historical advantage"</li> <li>• "beneficiary"</li> <li>• "benefits derived from the past"</li> <li>• "better positioning"</li> </ul>                                                      | e.g., Adelman (2016); Page (2012)              |
| <b>Climate Debt Justice</b>         |                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                |
| BL and<br>FB                        | UPP                  | Industrialized countries owe financial reparations, since they have accumulated a debt through the overuse of                                                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• "reparations"</li> <li>• "owed obligations"</li> <li>• "debt"</li> </ul>                                                                                                                    | e.g., OECD (1995); Parikh (1993)               |

|  |  |                                                                          |                                                                              |  |
|--|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
|  |  | common goods,the<br>atmosphere, with their<br>historical high emissions. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “atmospheric<br/>common”</li> </ul> |  |
|--|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|

## **Appendix B. Member countries of each alliance**

### **Appendix B1. Member countries of the EU**

|             |                |                 |
|-------------|----------------|-----------------|
| 1. Austria  | 10. France     | 19. Malta       |
| 2. Belgium  | 11. Germany    | 20. Netherlands |
| 3. Bulgaria | 12. Greece     | 21. Poland      |
| 4. Croatia  | 13. Hungary    | 22. Portugal    |
| 5. Cyprus   | 14. Ireland    | 23. Romania     |
| 6. Czechia  | 15. Italy      | 24. Slovakia    |
| 7. Denmark  | 16. Latvia     | 25. Slovenia    |
| 8. Estonia  | 17. Lithuania  | 26. Spain       |
| 9. Finland  | 18. Luxembourg | 27. Sweden      |

Source: EU (n.d.)

### **Appendix B2. Member countries of the AOSIS**

|                        |                                      |                                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1. Antigua and Barbuda | 14. Guyana                           | 27. São Tomé and Príncipe          |
| 2. Bahamas             | 15. Haiti                            | 28. Singapore                      |
| 3. Barbados            | 16. Jamaica                          | 29. St. Kitts and Nevis            |
| 4. Belize              | 17. Kiribati                         | 30. St. Lucia                      |
| 5. Cabo Verde          | 18. Maldives                         | 31. St. Vincent and the Grenadines |
| 6. Comoros             | 19. Marshall Islands                 | 32. Seychelles                     |
| 7. Cook Islands        | 20. Micronesia (Federated States of) | 33. Solomon Islands                |
| 8. Cuba                | 21. Mauritius                        | 34. Suriname                       |
| 9. Dominica            | 22. Nauru                            | 35. Timor-Leste                    |
| 10. Dominican Republic | 23. Niue                             | 36. Tonga                          |
| 11. Fiji               | 24. Palau                            | 37. Trinidad and Tobago            |
| 12. Grenada            | 25. Papua New Guinea                 | 38. Tuvalu                         |
| 13. Guinea-Bissau      | 26. Samoa                            | 39. Vanuatu                        |

Source: UN (n.d.)

### **Appendix B3. Member countries of the LMDC**

The LMDC group comprises “approximately 24 developing countries across Asia, Africa, and Latin America” (UNFCCC, n.d.). However, its exact membership number is difficult to determine as participation remains flexible. While some delegations engage across the full agenda, others support only selected statements aligned with their positions (Halkyer, 2021).

Here are some of the countries that have been assigned to the LMDC Group:

- |                                     |                 |                  |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|
| 1. Algeria                          | 10. El Salvador | 19. Pakistan     |
| 2. Argentina                        | 11. India       | 20. Philippines  |
| 3. Bolivia                          | 12. Iran        | 21. Qatar        |
| 4. Cuba                             | 13. Iraq        | 22. Saudi Arabia |
| 5. China                            | 14. Kuwait      | 23. Sri Lanka    |
| 6. Democratic Republic of the Congo | 15. Libya       | 24. Sudan        |
| 7. Dominica                         | 16. Malaysia    | 25. Syria        |
| 8. Ecuador                          | 17. Mali        | 26. Venezuela    |
| 9. Egypt                            | 18. Nicaragua   |                  |

Source: LMDC (2014)

### Appendix C: Documents of analysis

| Coalition/<br>Document | Topic | Issue (by UNFCCC)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Date       | Mandate                    | Session<br>Name | Notes |
|------------------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|----------------------------|-----------------|-------|
| AOSIS et al.           | NCQG  | Parties, constituted bodies under the Convention and the Paris Agreement, the operating entities of the Financial Mechanism, climate finance institutions, observers and observer organizations, and other stakeholders, particularly from the private sector are invited to submit their views on the objective in line with paragraph 15 and on the elements referred to in paragraph 16 via the submission portal | June 2022  | Decision 9/CMA.3, para. 17 | CMA 4           |       |
| Vanuatu                | NCQG  | Parties, constituted bodies under the Convention and the Paris Agreement, the operating entities of the Financial Mechanism, climate finance institutions, observers and observer organizations, and other stakeholders, particularly from the private sector are invited to submit their views on the objective in line with paragraph 15 and on the elements referred to in paragraph 16 via the submission portal | Feb 2022   | Decision 9/CMA.3, para. 17 | CMA 4           |       |
| AOSIS                  | NCQG  | Parties, constituted bodies under the Convention and the Paris Agreement, the operating entities of the Financial Mechanism, climate finance institutions, observers and observer organizations, and other stakeholders, particularly from the private sector are invited to submit their                                                                                                                            | Mar - 2022 | Decision 9/CMA.3, para. 17 | CMA 4           |       |

|               |                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |          |                                 |       |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|               |                                  | views on the objective in line with paragraph 15 and on the elements referred to in paragraph 16 via the submission portal                                                                                                                                                                |          |                                 |       |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Vanuatu       | NCQG                             | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Mar 2023 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 12 | CMA 5 |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| AOSIS         | NCQG workplan                    | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Mar 2024 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2023/L.10, para. 13 | CMA 6 |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| AOSIS and LDC | NCQG                             | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Jun 2024 | Decision 8/CMA.5, para. 14      | CMA 6 |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| AOSIS         | NCQG – draft elements            | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Jun 2024 | Decision 8/CMA.5, para. 14      | CMA 6 |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| AOSIS         | Darft Closing Statement for SB61 | Statements made at SBSTA61/SBI 61 joint closing plenary                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Nov 2024 | n/a                             | COP29 | While this paper provides good insights into AOSIS’s general position; we only include Paragraph 6, that this is the only paragraph which concerns itself with the new finance goal. |
| AOSIS         | Opening Statement COP29          | Statements made at COP 29/CMP 19/CMA 6/SBSTA 61/SBI 61 joint opening plenary                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Nov 2024 | n/a                             | COP29 | Only looking at paragraphs 18-23 since they are about the NCQG and the current finance architecture in general.                                                                      |
| EU            | NCQG                             | Parties, constituted bodies under the Convention and the Paris Agreement, the operating entities of the Financial Mechanism, climate finance institutions, observers and observer organizations, and other stakeholders, particularly from the private sector are invited to submit their | Oct 2022 | 9/CMA3, para. 17                | CMA 4 |                                                                                                                                                                                      |



|    |                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |          |                                    |       |  |
|----|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------|-------|--|
|    |                                                  | views on the objective in line with paragraph 15 and on the elements referred to in paragraph 16 via the submission portal.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |          |                                    |       |  |
| EU | NCQG                                             | Parties, constituted bodies under the Convention and the Paris Agreement, the operating entities of the Financial Mechanism, climate finance institutions, observers and observer organizations, and other stakeholders, particularly from the private sector are invited to submit their views on the objective in line with paragraph 15 and on the elements referred to in paragraph 16 via the submission portal | Mar 2022 | 9/CMA3, para. 17                   | CMA 4 |  |
| EU | NCQG workplan                                    | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Feb 2023 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 12    | CMA 5 |  |
| EU | TED7 under the ad hoc work Programme on the NCQG | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Jul 2023 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 11 b) | CMA 5 |  |
| EU | TED6 under the ad hoc work programme on the NCQG | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | May 2023 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 11 b) | CMA 5 |  |
| EU | TED8 under the ad hoc work programme On the NCQG | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Nov 2023 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 11 b) | CMA 5 |  |

|       |                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |          |                                 |       |                                                                                           |
|-------|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EU    | TED11 and MAHWP3 on the NCQG |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Aug 2024 | Decision 8/CMA.5, para. 14      | CMA 6 |                                                                                           |
| EU    | NCQG workplan                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Jan 2024 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2023/L.10, para. 13 | CMA 6 |                                                                                           |
| EU    | NCQG                         | Input to Co-Chairs after 1st MAHWP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2024     | n/a                             | n/a   |                                                                                           |
| EU    | Opening Statement COP29      | Statements made at COP 29/CMP 19/CMA 6/SBSTA 61/SBI 61 joint opening plenary                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Nov 2024 | n/a                             | COP29 | Only analysing the last paragraph on the first page, which concerns itself with the NCQG. |
| India | NCQG                         | Parties, constituted bodies under the Convention and the Paris Agreement, the operating entities of the Financial Mechanism, climate finance institutions, observers and observer organizations, and other stakeholders, particularly from the private sector are invited to submit their views on the objective in line with paragraph 15 and on the elements referred to in paragraph 16 via the submission portal | Feb 2022 | Decision 9/CMA.3, para. 17      | CMA 4 |                                                                                           |
| LMDC  | NCQG                         | Parties, constituted bodies under the Convention and the Paris Agreement, the operating entities of the Financial Mechanism, climate finance institutions, observers and observer organizations, and other stakeholders, particularly from the private sector are invited to submit their views on the objective in line with paragraph 15 and on the elements referred to in paragraph                              | Mar 2022 | Decision 9/CMA3, para. 17       | CMA 4 |                                                                                           |

|       |                                                                                                  |                              |            |                                    |       |  |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------|-------|--|
|       |                                                                                                  | 16 via the submission portal |            |                                    |       |  |
| LMDC  | AHWP on NCQG workplan                                                                            | NCQG                         | Feb 2023   | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 12    | CMA 5 |  |
| India | AHWP on NCQG workplan                                                                            | NCQG                         | Feb 2023   | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 12    | CMA 5 |  |
| LMDC  | TED7 under the ad hoc work Programme on the NCQG                                                 | NCQG                         | Sep 2023   | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 11 b) | CMA 5 |  |
| LMDC  | TED6 under the ad hoc work programme on the NCQG                                                 | NCQG                         | May 2023   | FCCC/PA/CMA/2022/L.19, para. 11 b) | CMA 5 |  |
| LMDC  | TED9 and the first meeting of the ad-hoc work program on the NCQG                                | NCQG                         | April 2024 | Decision 8/CMA.5, para. 14         | CMA 6 |  |
| LMDC  | Interventions delivered during TED9 and the first meeting of the ad-hoc work program on the NCQG | NCQG                         | April 2024 | Decision 8/CMA.5, para. 14         | CMA 6 |  |
| LMDC  | NCQG workplan                                                                                    | NCQG                         | Feb 2024   | FCCC/PA/CMA/2023/L.10, para. 13    | CMA 6 |  |

|                         |                              |                                                                                                                                                                     |          |                                 |       |                                                                                     |
|-------------------------|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| India                   | NCQG workplan                | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                | Feb 2024 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2023/L.10, para. 13 | CMA 6 |                                                                                     |
| LMDC                    | TED11 and MAHWP3 on the NCQG | NCQG                                                                                                                                                                | Aug 2024 | Decision 8/CMA.5, para. 14      | CMA 6 |                                                                                     |
| LMDC                    | Opening Statement COP29      | Statements made at COP 29/CMP 19/CMA 6/SBSTA 61/SBI 61 joint opening plenary                                                                                        | Nov 2024 | n/a                             | COP29 | Analysing the whole document since each paragraph is related to finance provisions. |
| Final Decision Document | Final Decision Dokument      | Report of the Conference of the Parties serving as the meeting of the Parties to the Paris Agreement on its sixth session, held in Baku from 11 to 24 November 2024 | Mar 2025 | FCCC/PA/CMA/2024/17/Add. 1      | CMA 6 |                                                                                     |

\*TED = technical expert dialogue

\* Meeting under the Ad Hoc Work Programme (MAHWP)

### Appendix D1. Final framework

| Deductive/<br>Inductive             | Paying<br>Principles | FL/BL<br>FB/N-F | Arguments                                                                                                                           | Target terms                                                                                                                                          | Theoretical Source                                                                                                                                 | Notes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Distributive Climate Justice</b> |                      |                 |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Deductive                           | APP                  | FL and<br>N-FB  | Regarding each country' capabilities and circumstances, the provision of climate finance should be determined.                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “equity”</li> <li>• “fair allocation”</li> <li>• “equitable allocation”</li> <li>• “capabilities”</li> </ul> | e.g., Adelman (2016); Paavola and Adger (2006)                                                                                                     | Only mentioning Art. 9 PA, or the CBDR-RC is not considered in this frame, since the CBDR-RC is a separate principle, which includes states contributions to GHG emissions but also considers their capabilities and national circumstances (Foster, 2025). |
| Inductive                           | Equity and Fairness  | FL and<br>N-FB  | The provision of climate finance must be shared in a fair and equitable way, considering the special needs of developing countries. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “Burden-sharing”</li> <li>• “Fair-share”</li> <li>• “Equity”</li> </ul>                                      | Emergred in the AOSIS and LMDC submissions and reflects a focus on equitable allocation of responsibilities and resources (Bastos & Duleba, 2025). | Only mentioning Art. 9 PA, equity, or CBDR-RC is not considered in this frame, since the CBDR-RC is a separate principle, which includes states contributions to GHG emissions but also considers their capabilities and national                           |

|                                   |               |             |                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                               |
|-----------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|                                   |               |             |                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | circumstances (Foster, 2025). |
| Inductive                         | Solidarity    | FL and N-FB | Climate finance should be provided based on solidarity with other countries.                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “solidarity”</li> <li>• “collective support”</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                  | Emerged in the EU’s submissions and is based on support for the least advantaged actors (Khan et al., 2019).                                                                                                                     |                               |
| Inductive                         | Global effort | FL and N-FB | All countries must contribute to the provision of climate finance.                                                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “global effort”</li> <li>• “collective goal”</li> <li>• “jointly”</li> <li>• “all parties”</li> </ul>                                                                                    | Emerged in the EU’s submissions and aligns with the equitable allocation of responsibilities among all actors according to their present circumstances and capabilities (Bastos & Duleba, 2025; Jagers & Duus-Otterström, 2008). |                               |
| <b>Corrective Climate Justice</b> |               |             |                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                               |
| Deductive                         | PPP           | FL and FB   | Independent of past emissions, current and future polluters are responsible to provide the financial means against climate change. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “compensation”</li> <li>• “rectification”</li> <li>• “restoration”</li> <li>• “fault”</li> <li>• “wrongs”</li> <li>• “current polluters/emitters”</li> <li>• “Carbon pricing”</li> </ul> | Shue (1999)                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                               |

|           |                |             |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                         |  |
|-----------|----------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| Deductive | PPP            | BL and FB   | Industrialized countries must, due to their high historical emissions, provide financial compensation to tackle the adverse effects of climate change.                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “compensation”</li> <li>• “rectification”</li> <li>• “restoration”</li> <li>• “fault”</li> <li>• “wrongs”</li> <li>• “historical emissions/emitters”</li> <li>• “past pollution”</li> </ul> | e.g., Caney (2005); Okereke (2010)                                                                                                      |  |
| Deductive | BPP            | BL and FB   | The current generation of industrialized countries must provide climate finance, since they have derived benefits from past emissions, positioning them better than descendants of low-emitting countries. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “beneficiary”</li> <li>• “benefits”</li> <li>• “better positioning”</li> </ul>                                                                                                              | e.g., Adelman (2016); Page (2012)                                                                                                       |  |
| Inductive | Lessons learnt | BL and FB   | The new climate finance goal must correct the wrongs of the past finance goal.                                                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “lessons learned”</li> <li>• “unmet”</li> <li>• “shortcomings”</li> <li>• “rectify deficiencies”</li> </ul>                                                                                 | Can primarily be found in the AOSIS and LMDC submissions and focuses on rectifying past wrongdoings (Khan et al., 2019; Okereke, 2010). |  |
|           |                | BL and N-FB | Learning from past mistakes allows to improve the new finance goal.                                                                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• improve”</li> <li>• “take into account”</li> <li>• “incorporate”</li> </ul>                                                                                                                 | Can primarily be found in the EU’s submissions and focuses on improving past                                                            |  |

|                             |                                   |             |                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                          |  |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
|                             |                                   |             |                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | mistakes (Khan et al., 2019; Okereke, 2010).                                                                                             |  |
| <b>Climate Debt Justice</b> |                                   |             |                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                          |  |
| Deductive                   | UPP                               | BL and FB   | Industrialized countries owe financial reparations, since they have accumulated a debt through the overused of common good, the atmosphere with their historical high emissions. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “reparations”</li> <li>• “owe”</li> <li>• “debt”</li> <li>• “overuse”</li> <li>• “atmospheric common”</li> </ul>                                                                          | OECD (1995); Parikh (1993)                                                                                                               |  |
| Inductive                   | Debt-creating financial mechanism | BL and FB   | The provision of climate finance should not create or add any additional burdens for the recipients of climate finance, since it is reparations.                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “added burden”</li> <li>• “exacerbating indebtedness”</li> <li>• “systemic inequities, such as high costs”</li> <li>• “additional costs”</li> </ul>                                       | Can primarily be found in the AOSIS and LMDC submissions and requires to repay debts or at least avoid additional ones (Dafermos, 2025). |  |
|                             |                                   | BL and N-FB | Climate finance provisions must ensure the avoidance of debt-creating mechanisms.                                                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “take into account existing debt levels”</li> <li>• “debt avoidance”</li> <li>• “debt relief/forgiveness”</li> <li>• “enable debt sustainability”</li> <li>• “not exacerbated”</li> </ul> | Can primarily be found in the EU’s submissions and concentrates on avoiding additional debt burdens through the provision of climate     |  |



|  |  |  |  |                                                                            |                           |  |
|--|--|--|--|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|--|
|  |  |  |  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>“addressing constraints”</li> </ul> | finance (Dafermos, 2025). |  |
|--|--|--|--|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|--|

## Appendix D2. Text-Examples of final frames.

| Paying Principles                   | FL/BL<br>FB/N-F | Text-Examples                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Distributive Climate Justice</b> |                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| APP                                 | FL and N-FB     | To achieve an ambitious outcome on the NCQG by agreeing on the overall scale of the quantum, <b>ensuring that the group of contributors is broadened including to those Parties that are capable to do so</b> and the collective responsibility to contribute reflecting global solidarity, making sure that the finance flows to those who are most vulnerable, while driving the mobilization of finance at scale towards the Paris Agreement objectives – <i>EU Nov 2024</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Equity and Fairness                 | FL and N-FB     | Negative example: “ Moreover, it is a fact that adaptation projects are already financed by funds of public origin, that is, <b>developing countries already pay more than their fair share of the consequences of climate change</b> , to the detriment of their development need” – <i>LMDC March 2022</i><br><br>“ <b>Fair, just, and equitable burden sharing of responsibility for the goal’s achievement</b> based on the developed country Parties’ individual respective shares of historical emissions of greenhouse gases” – <i>AOSIS Jun 2024</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Solidarity                          | FL and N-FB     | Acknowledging that Parties’ GHG-emissions as well as economic capabilities are dynamic, have evolved and will continue to evolve, <b>thus providing an opportunity to reflect strong global solidarity by increasing finance to support vulnerable countries and communities.</b><br>– <i>EU Aug 2024</i><br><br>“However, in contrast to the provision of finance, mobilisation of climate finance from various sources, including public and private, domestic and international, is a global effort, in which the developed countries will continue to take the lead, but where domestic action in all countries is needed, e.g. through the integration of climate into national budget and planning processes, and measures to ensure an attractive investment climate. This global effort should be reflected in the new goal, <b>based on solidarity, responsibility, and ability of actors to contribute</b> according to the principles of common but differentiated responsibility, but also respective |

|                                   |             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                   |             | capabilities, acknowledging the dynamic nature of these capabilities.” – <i>EU May 2023</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Global effort                     | FL and N-FB | <p>“<b>We stress that mobilising climate finance is a global effort with the aim to strengthen the global response to climate change.</b> According to Article 9.1 and 9.3 of the Paris Agreement and as part of a global effort, developed country Parties should continue to take the lead in mobilizing climate finance. At the same time, it is important to acknowledge that the world has changed in the last decades and that a climate resilient society needs to involve all stakeholders in all countries. <b>In order to contribute effectively to the objective of the Convention and to implement the Paris Agreement, the NCQG needs to be seen as a global effort</b> and in this light, Parties, other than developed country Parties, that are in the position to do so should also provide financial support. Those already providing support should be recognized for their efforts. <b>Only in global cooperation can we enable the climate action that is urgently needed.</b>” – <i>EU Mar 2022</i></p> <p>“The EU and its Member States recognise their responsibility in providing assistance to the most vulnerable developing countries as a core layer of the new goal, and <b>their leading role in the global effort in the mobilisation of climate financial flows, both international and domestic, public and private.</b>” – <i>EU May 2023</i></p> |
| <b>Corrective Climate Justice</b> |             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| PPP                               | FL and FB   | <p>“Acknowledges the evolving common but differentiated responsibilities of all Parties in terms of cumulative emissions in the atmosphere, and the <b>dynamic and evolving nature of respective capabilities to contribute</b> to address the threat of climate change and support the implementation of ambitious NDCs” – <i>EU Aug 2024</i></p> <p>“<b>The responsibility particularly from larger emitters is inescapable.</b> Without the G20, we cannot bend the global emissions curve toward net zero in line with the IPCC assessment of the need to peak global emissions before 2025 and halve them by 2030 to limit warming to 1.5°C.” – <i>AOSIS Nov 2024</i></p> <p>“The UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (Convention) and its Paris Agreement have underscored the critical requirement of climate</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

|                 |           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                 |           | finance flow from the developed country Parties to the developing country Parties. The Convention acknowledged that the largest share of historical and <b>current global emissions of greenhouse gases have originated from the developed countries</b> , recognizing also that developing countries would need increasing amount of the carbon space to meet their developmental needs.” – <i>India Feb 2022</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| PPP             | BL and FB | <p>“<b>The quantum needs to reflect</b> changed economic realities, <b>historic</b> and current <b>responsibilities</b>, and global solidarity.” – <i>EU May 2023</i></p> <p>“There shall be fair, just and equitable burden sharing amongst developed country Parties for achieving the goal <b>based on their share of historical emissions of greenhouse gases.</b>” – <i>AOSIS Jun 2024</i></p> <p>“<b>Such support must first take into account the historical obligations of the developed countries</b>, and the principle of common but differentiated responsibilities, and must not increase the existing indebtedness confronting many developing countries as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic.” – <i>LMDC Mar 2022</i></p> |
| BPP             | BL and FB | <p>“In the same submission India had proposed that <b>0.5 percent of the total GDP of the developed world should be mobilized for funding full agreed incremental costs of adaptation and mitigation through resource transfers or grants.</b> On country specific contribution to this collection goal, <b>a multilateral consensus on the basis of historical responsibility for GHG concentration, current emission levels, per capita GDP etc.</b> was proposed.” – <i>India Feb 2022</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Lessons learned | BL and FB | <p>“<b>There are lessons to be learnt from the past.</b> The way forward is actually capturing the data at a granular level in a transparent way to bring the credibility and accuracy of the numbers reported and addresses the principles of adequacy and predictability. <b>Building upon the lessons learned from the unmet \$100 billion target, developed nations must adopt a proactive stance towards fulfilling their climate finance commitments. By addressing past shortcomings and rectifying deficiencies,</b> developed countries can instill greater confidence and trust in the climate finance process, fostering a conducive environment for effective collaboration and progress.” – <i>India Feb 2024</i></p>       |

|                                    |             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                    | BL and N-FB | <p>“In order to contribute effectively to the implementation of the Paris Agreement as outlined above, <b>it is key to draw from the lessons learned from implementing the USD 100 billion goal and improve efforts based on past experience.</b>” – EU Mar 2022</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Climate Debt Justice</b>        |             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| UPP                                | BL and FB   | <p><b>“Climate Finance is an obligation of the developed world to the developing world owing to their (developed countries) stock of GHG in the atmosphere.”</b> – <i>India Feb 2024</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Debt-creating financial mechanisms | BL and FB   | <p>“The climate finance landscape is fragmented, and the resulting complexity associated with accessing funds is especially challenging for SIDS. The scale of finance provided and mobilized for SIDS is grossly disproportionate to the scale of our needs which are continuing to multiply exponentially as the world heats up. <b>Worse yet is the decline of grant-based adaptation finance that is critical to our islands. If SIDS are to have a fighting chance of sustaining ourselves and contributing to the 1.5 agenda, then we must have access to adequate, predictable, scaled up finance and we need a more coordinated and coherent landscape for this to happen.</b>” – <i>AOSIS Nov 2024</i></p> <p>“In an era of economic challenges, particularly impacting developing countries, the need for concessional and grant-based financing from developed countries is ever more pronounced. <b>Support provided to developing countries should not add any additional economic burdens,</b> but rather enable effective implementation of climate priorities. <b>The approach to ensuring that economic challenges are not exacerbated</b> should be utilized by developed countries and reflect the principles of equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities, in light of different national circumstances.” – <i>LMDC Sep 2023</i></p> |

|  |             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | BL and N-FB | <p><b>“Determination of concessionality level of transactions must take into account the existing levels of debt servicing capacity of developing countries, in particular for LDCs and SIDS.” – AOSIS Jun 2024</b></p> <p><b>“Acknowledge the challenges faced by developing countries and encourage use of (innovative) instruments aimed at addressing them as part of climate finance, incl. highly concessional finance, de-risking instruments, debt-swaps etc.).” – EU May 2024</b></p> |
|--|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### Appendix D3. Text-Examples of contributor base.

| Position                                        | Text-Example                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Supporting an expansion of the contributor base | <p><b>“The core of the goal will be delivered by a broader contributor base based on set criteria, reflecting economic capabilities as well as GHG emissions, acknowledging that capabilities to contribute have evolved since the early 1990s and will continue to evolve. Such criteria would allow for a dynamic contributor base reflecting evolving capabilities.” – EU May 2024</b></p> <p><b>“AOSIS recognizes that while the new goal is principally directed to developed country Parties, the new goal would also need to consider any private climate finance mobilized through public interventions.” – AOSIS Mar 2022</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Opposing an expansion of the contributor base   | <p><b>“NCQG is a developed countries' commitment for the provision of public funding and their leadership in mobilizing climate finance to developing countries” – AOSIS et al. Jun 2022</b></p> <p><b>“Article 9, paragraphs 1, 2 and 3 outline finance obligations and makes it clear that developed countries are to provide finance to developing countries. The New Collective Quantified Goal on Climate Finance does not have the mandate to discuss contributors to the goal as it has never been cited in a previous decision. The discussion on contributors is therefore not substantiated in the NCQG process and the options discussed therein will not be useful to the CMA as it does not have a mandate to respond to such options. The exploration of contributors will not yield any productive outcome and the options produced cannot be decided upon within the NCQG agenda item this upcoming CMA in any case. The co-chairs of the ad hoc work programme of the NCQG, should therefore ensure</b></p> |

|  |                                                                                                                                   |
|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | that the topics of the technical expert dialogues are substantiated by the mandate of the NCQG process” –<br><i>LMDC Mar 2022</i> |
|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Appendix E. Pearson Chi-Square Tests of Independence: Variations in Frame Use.

### Appendix E1. Variations in use of climate justice theories across coalitions.

| Test                                             | $\chi^2$ | df | p value   | Cramer's V |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------|----|-----------|------------|
| Coalition $\times$ climate justice theory frames | = 23.786 | 4  | < .001*** | = .306     |

Note: Statistical significance is determined with  $p < .05^*$ ,  $p < .01^{**}$ , and  $p < .001^{***}$ .

### Appendix E2. Calculation of Cramer's V effect size for a 3x3 contingency table.

Small effect size:  $\frac{0.10}{\sqrt{2}} \approx 0.07$

Medium effect size:  $\frac{0.30}{\sqrt{2}} \approx 0.21$

Large effect size:  $\frac{0.50}{\sqrt{2}} \approx 0.35$

### Appendix E3. Variations in frame use of paying principles across coalitions.

| Test                                      | $\chi^2$ | df | p value   | Cramer's V |
|-------------------------------------------|----------|----|-----------|------------|
| Coalition $\times$ FB and N-FB principles | = 32.454 | 2  | < .001*** | = .520     |

Note: Statistical significance is determined with  $p < .05^*$ ,  $p < .01^{**}$ , and  $p < .001^{***}$ .



## References:

- Adelman, S. (2016). Climate justice, loss and damage and compensation for small island developing states. *Journal of Human Rights and the Environment*, 7(1), 32–53.  
<https://doi.org/10.4337/jhre.2016.01.02>
- Bastos, M. F. R., & Duleba, W. (2025). The new climate fund for loss and damage of the Paris Agreement: Discussions on financing and climate justice. *Revista Brasileira de Política Internacional*, 68(1), e003. <https://doi.org/10.1590/0034-7329202500103>
- Caney, S. (2005). Cosmopolitan Justice, Responsibility, and Global Climate Change. *Leiden Journal of International Law*, 18(4), 747–775.  
<https://doi.org/10.1017/S0922156505002992>
- Dafermos, Y. (2025). Climate finance and global justice. *Climate Policy*, 1–17.  
<https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2025.2482104>
- EU. (n.d.). *EU countries*. [https://european-union.europa.eu/principles-countries-history/eu-countries\\_en?page=0](https://european-union.europa.eu/principles-countries-history/eu-countries_en?page=0)
- Foster, C. E. (2025). The 2025 International Court of Justice Advisory Opinion on *Obligations of States in respect of Climate Change*. *International and Comparative Law Quarterly*, 74(4), 775–809. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0020589325101292>
- Halkyer, R. O. (2021). COP 21 – Complaints and Negotiation: The Role of the Like-Minded Developing Countries Group (LMDC) and the Paris Agreement. In H. Jepsen, M. Lundgren, K. Monheim, & H. Walker (Hrsg.), *Negotiating the Paris Agreement* (1. Aufl., S. 160–181). Cambridge University Press.  
<https://doi.org/10.1017/9781108886246.009>
- Jagers, S. C., & Duus-Otterström, G. (2008). Dual climate change responsibility: On moral divergences between mitigation and adaptation. *Environmental Politics*, 17(4), 576–591. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09644010802193443>

- Khan, M., Robinson, S., Ciplet, D., & Roberts, J. T. (2019). Twenty-five years of adaptation finance through a climate justice lens. *Climatic Change*, 161(2), 251–269.  
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s10584-019-02563-x>
- LMDC. (2014). *Submission on Elements of the 2015 Agreed Outcome – 8 March 2014*.  
[http://unfccc.int/files/documentation/submissions\\_from\\_parties/adp/application/pdf/adp\\_lmdc\\_ws1\\_20140309.pdf](http://unfccc.int/files/documentation/submissions_from_parties/adp/application/pdf/adp_lmdc_ws1_20140309.pdf)
- OECD. (1995). *ENVIRONMENTAL PRINCIPLES AND CONCEPTS* (General Distribution OCDE/GD(95)124).
- Okereke, C. (2010). Climate justice and the international regime. *WIREs Climate Change*, 1(3), 462–474. <https://doi.org/10.1002/wcc.52>
- Paavola, J., & Adger, W. N. (2006). Fair adaptation to climate change. *Ecological Economics*, 56(4), 594–609. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecolecon.2005.03.015>
- Page, E. A. (2012). Give it up for climate change: A defence of the beneficiary pays principle. *International Theory*, 4(2), 300–330.  
<https://doi.org/10.1017/S175297191200005X>
- Parikh, K. S. (1993). The Polluter-Pays and User-Pays Principles for developing countries; merits, drawbacks and feasibility. In E. Dommen (Hrsg.), *Fair Principles for Sustainable Development* (S. 81–92). Edward Elgar Publishing.  
<https://doi.org/10.4337/9781035303083.00011>
- Shue, H. (1999). Global Environment and International Inequality. *International Affairs*, 75(3), 531–545. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1468-2346.00092>
- UN. (n.d.). *List of SIDS*. <https://www.un.org/ohrlls/content/list-sids>
- UNFCCC. (n.d.). *Party Groupings*. <https://unfccc.int/process-and-meetings/parties-non-party-stakeholders/parties/party-groupings>